

RAS Prelims 2026 · Handwritten Class Notes

Current Affairs and Contemporary Issues

Chapter-by-chapter notes in coaching-lecture style — concept first, then the facts, with flow charts, mind maps, previous-year callouts and current-affairs links.

CA01 *Rajasthan Current Affairs: Schemes, Policies, Government Decisions*

CA02 *Rajasthan: Awards, Events, Sports, Personalities, Places*

CA03 *National Affairs: Polity, Governance and Schemes*

CA04 *National Economy and Union Budget*

CA05 *International Affairs and Organisations*

CA06 *Science, Technology, Environment and Defence in the News*

CA07 *Sports, Awards, Books, Persons and Places in the News*

RPSC RAS & RTS Preliminary Examination · 6 December 2026 · 150 questions · 200 marks · 1/3 negative marking

CA01

Rajasthan Current Affairs: Schemes, Policies, Government Decisions

About 10-12 questions a paper, and the highest-value chapter in the whole set. Expect budget numbers, scheme name-to-purpose matching, policy years, the district and division count, and at least one appointment question. Notes current to September 2026 — you must add October and November yourself.

The state budget, the schemes that keep getting renamed, the policy wave after Rising Rajasthan, the district count, the big projects and who holds which chair. RPSC builds 10 to 12 questions a paper out of this and sources them from state press notes rather than any book — which is why it is rated the hardest block in the paper every single year.

Rajasthan Current Affairs (to September 2026)

Budget 2026-27

- Viksit Rajasthan @2047
- ₹6,10,956 cr
- 3.69% deficit
- RAJ-SURAKSHA, PRITHWI, Raj-AIMS

Budget 2025-26

- First green budget
- 4.25% deficit
- Ram Jal Setu ₹9,300 cr
- Brahmagupta Centre

Renamed schemes

- Chiranjeevi to Ayushman Arogya
- Indira Rasoi to Shree Annapurna Rasoi
- PKC-ERCP to Ram Jal Setu
- Bhamashah to Jan Aadhaar

Policies by year

- 2023 Green Hydrogen
- 2024 M-Sand, MSME, AVGC-XR
- 2025 GCC, Logistics
- 2026 Semiconductor, AI-ML

Rising Rajasthan

- December 2024
- ₹35 lakh cr MoUs
- Energy ₹6.19 lakh cr
- ₹8 lakh cr grounded

Districts

- 19 created 2023
- 9 + 3 divisions scrapped 2024
- 41 districts
- 7 divisions

Big projects

- Ram Jal Setu, 17 districts
- Pachpadra, Balotra
- Bhadla solar
- Jaipur Metro Phase 2

Laws 2026

- UCC Bill 14 Aug
- Wage Code 7 Aug
- Trees Protection Bill
- One State One Election

Appointments

- Governor Bagde
- CS Voruganti Srinivas
- DGP Rajeev Kumar Sharma
- RPSC Utkal Ranjan Sahoo

Conservation

- 5 Ramsar sites
- 5 tiger reserves
- Kumbhalgarh proposed 6th
- Khichan, Menar 2025

Before you start — how to keep this chapter alive

Rajasthan current affairs is not a chapter you learn once. It is a chapter you maintain. Every other block in this paper — history, geography, polity — is settled knowledge. This one moves. RPSC picks it up from state press notes, the budget speech and Rajasthan Sujas, not from any book. That is exactly why it is rated the hardest block in the paper every single year. These notes are current to September 2026 and the exam is on 6 December 2026, so there is a

live gap of about two and a half months that you have to fill yourself. Do not wait for a coaching handout in November. Build the habit now — twenty minutes a week.

- Everything dated here carries an explicit 'as of September 2026'. Treat undated numbers as fixed.
- Sources to add from: dipr.rajasthan.gov.in press releases, Rajasthan Sujas monthly, the state budget portal.
- Watch four moving things: office-holders, court and cabinet decisions, new policies, scheme renamings.
- Keep one page at the back of this chapter titled 'Oct-Nov 2026' and add one line a week to it.
- RPSC's current-affairs window for a December paper realistically runs from about January to October 2026.

CURRENT LINK

What is most likely to change between now and the exam (as of September 2026): the Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court, the fate of the UCC Bill in the Assembly, fresh sectoral policy notifications, and any new commission chairperson. Everything else in this chapter is reasonably stable.

Rajasthan Budget 2026-27 — the headline numbers

Start with the budget. It is the single densest source of question material in this whole chapter. The 2026-27 budget was presented in February 2026 by Diya Kumari, who is Deputy Chief Minister and Finance Minister. The theme is 'Viksit Rajasthan @2047'. Learn the theme first — a theme question is the easiest mark in the section.

Budget 2026-27 — the numbers to memorise

Item	Figure
Presented by	Diya Kumari, Deputy CM and Finance Minister, February 2026
Theme	Viksit Rajasthan @2047
Total outlay	About ₹6,10,956 crore
GSDP projected	₹21,52,100 crore (about ₹21.5 lakh crore)
Fiscal deficit	₹79,493 crore = 3.69% of GSDP
Per capita income	₹1.68 lakh, projected to rise to ₹2.02 lakh
New taxes	None

Budget 2026-27 — the four thematic outlays

Theme budget	Outlay
Agriculture budget	₹1,19,408 crore
Gender budget	₹74,312 crore
Child budget	₹51,138 crore
Green budget	₹33,475 crore

- Employment target: 1 lakh government jobs in the year.
- Roads: a 42,000 km road network target, of which 16,430 km is new construction.
- 250 Atal Pragati Paths with ₹500 crore.
- 400 government schools to be upgraded as CM-RISE schools with ₹1,000 crore.
- 7,500 Nand Ghar anganwadis with ₹225 crore.
- ₹25,000 crore of interest-free short-term crop loans to more than 35 lakh farmers.

Budget 2026-27 — the new names and the sector announcements

Now the part that actually decides the mark. The 2026-27 budget threw up a dozen new capitalised programme names, and RPSC's favourite format for this is name-to-purpose matching. You will not be asked what PRITHWI costs. You will be asked what PRITHWI is for. So learn the name and the one-line purpose. Nothing more.

Budget 2026-27 — new names and what each one does

Name	What it is for
RAJ-SURAKSHA	Emergency medical response
RAJ-MAMTA	Mental health; Centre of Excellence at SMS Medical College, Jaipur
RAJ-SETU	Urban infrastructure financing
Raj-PAHAL	Education of nomadic and migrant children — 'School on Wheels'
VIBRANT	Mentoring and entrepreneurship development in colleges
DREAM	Programme covering 50,000 college students
Raj-AIMS	Digital Agriculture Mission using AI and satellite data
Mission Raj GIFT	GI tagging and better price realisation for farm produce
PRITHWI	Wildlife and terrestrial habitat conservation, about ₹1,500 crore
Mission Hariyali Rajasthan	10 crore saplings
R4C	Cyber Crime Control Centre
Panch Gaurav Yojana	₹150 crore
Amrit Poshan Vatika	11,000 nutrition gardens

TRAP

The acronyms are deliberately confusable and RPSC will exploit that. RAJ-SETU is urban infrastructure financing — it is NOT emergency medical response (that is RAJ-SURAKSHA) and NOT a tribal coaching scheme. RAJ-MAMTA is mental health, not maternal health, despite the name.

Budget 2026-27 — water and energy announcements

Announcement	Detail
Yamuna water project	₹32,000 crore for the Shekhawati region — Jhunjhunu, Churu, Sikar
Tap water	About ₹4,500 crore for roughly 6,450 villages
Bisalpur-Bikaner drinking water	₹250 crore
Solar parks	About 4,630 MW, about ₹2,900 crore — Bikaner (Nokha-Daitras-Napasar), Bap-Phalodi, Jaisalmer (Ramgarh-Lachhuda)
Grid substations	6 of 220 kV, 13 of 132 kV and 110 of 33 kV
AI-enabled grid	Ajmer Discom

Budget 2026-27 — new institutions and tax changes

Item	Detail
Rajasthan State Testing Agency	Recruitment testing body on the National Testing Agency model
AI Centres of Excellence	Two to be set up
State Drone Cell	Plus a state Drone Policy
Rajasthan Jan Vishwas Act 2.0	Decriminalisation of minor offences
Registration charge	Cut from 1% to 0.5% on documents up to ₹1 lakh
Stamp duty	Cut from 0.25% to 0.125%; stamp-paper surcharge raised 30% to 33%

- Women: Mukhyamantri Lakhpati Didi loan limit raised from ₹1 lakh to ₹1.5 lakh.
- Women: Mukhyamantri Nari Shakti Udyam Protsahan Yojana loan limit raised to ₹1 crore.
- Women: rural women's BPOs at the DISTRICT level with ₹100 crore — not block level, not ₹500 crore.

- *Tourism: ultra-luxury special tourism zone at Khuri, Jaisalmer; war museum at Jhunjhunu.*
- *Tourism: Thar Cultural Circuit covering Jodhpur, Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Barmer and Jalore.*
- *Tourism: Braj Convention Centre at Bharatpur with ₹100 crore.*
- *Industry: new industrial parks at Hindaun (Karauli), Jaisamand (Salumber) and Pachpadra (Balotra), about ₹400 crore.*
- *Horticulture Mission: olive, date palm and pomegranate in arid areas, about ₹1,100 crore.*
- *Also announced: Skill Mentor Board and a centralised GIS lab.*

Budget 2025-26 versus Budget 2026-27 — the contrast RPSC can build a statement question on

Budget 2025-26	Budget 2026-27
Presented 19 February 2025	Presented February 2026
First 'green theme' budget	Theme: Viksit Rajasthan @2047
Fiscal deficit ₹84,643.63 crore = 4.25% of GSDP	Fiscal deficit ₹79,493 crore = 3.69% of GSDP
GSDP over ₹19,89,000 crore	GSDP ₹21,52,100 crore
1.25 lakh government posts	1 lakh government jobs
Sardar Patel Centre for Cyber Control, ₹350 crore	R4C Cyber Crime Control Centre
Target: USD 350 billion economy by 2030	Target: Viksit Rajasthan by 2047

Rajasthan Budget 2025-26 — the green budget

Do not drop the 2025-26 budget just because a newer one exists. RPSC's current-affairs window for a December 2026 paper comfortably reaches back into 2025, and the 2025-26 budget is where the big infrastructure commitments were made — Ram Jal Setu, the expressways, the metro. Its

identity marker is that it was presented as Rajasthan's FIRST green theme-based budget, on 19 February 2025. If a question says 'first green budget of the state', the answer is 2025-26.

Budget 2025-26 — flagship allocations

Item	Allocation
Ram Jal Setu Link Project	₹9,300 crore
Nine greenfield expressways	₹60,000 crore
Jaipur Metro	₹12,000 crore
Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Urban Development	₹12,050 crore over seven years
MAA Fund	₹3,500 crore
Free electricity	150 units a month to eligible domestic consumers

Budget 2025-26 — the green ten and the tech-security block

Item	Detail
Climate Adaptation Plan	For 2030 — not 2047
Centre of Excellence for Climate Change	₹150 crore
CM Water Self-Reliance Campaign 2.0	₹2,700 crore
Solar Didi	25,000 women trained in solar equipment
Green Challenge Fund	₹100 crore
Green Aravali Development Project	₹250 crore
Sardar Patel Centre for Cyber Control	₹350 crore, plus 8 new cyber police stations
Brahmagupta Frontier Technologies Centre	₹300 crore — named after the ancient mathematician
RajNET 2.0	₹400 crore
Disaster Recovery Data Centre	Jodhpur

- Employment: Rajasthan Employment Policy-2025 announced.

- Vivekananda Employment Assistance Fund with a ₹500 crore corpus.
- 1.25 lakh government posts to be filled.
- Vishwakarma Yuva Udham Protsahan Yojana — 8% interest subsidy on loans up to ₹2 crore.
- Gig Workers Fund of ₹350 crore.
- Gopal Credit Card — ₹150 crore, covering about 2.50 lakh cowherds (gopalaks).

Budget 2025-26 — specialised parks and their locations

Park	Location
Toy Park	Kota
Stone Park	Nimbahera, Chittorgarh
Ceramic Park	Soniana
Pharma Park	DMIC
Textile Park expansion	Bhilwara
Single Window 'One Stop Shop'	Permissions raised to 149

State schemes — the renamed ones, and the ones running now

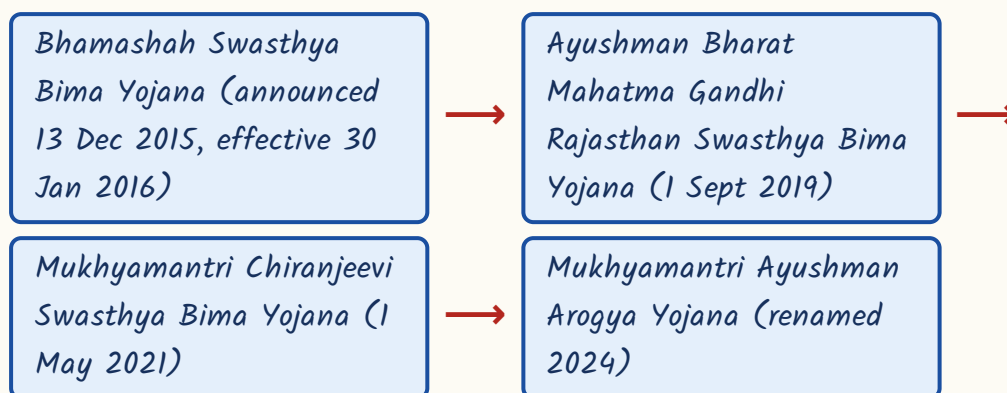
This is where students lose marks they should not lose. Rajasthan changes government and the schemes get renamed, but the scheme itself keeps running. RPSC then asks the question using either the old name or the new one — and sometimes builds a match-the-following out of exactly that. So you must carry both names in your head for every renamed scheme.

Old name to new name — learn both columns

Former name	Current name
Mukhyamantri Chiranjeevi Swasthya Bima Yojana	Mukhyamantri Ayushman Arogya Yojana (renamed 2024)

Former name	Current name
Indira Rasoi Yojana	Shree Annapurna Rasoi Yojana (renamed 5 January 2024)
Mukhyamantri Rajshri Yojana	Merged into Lado Protsahan Yojana
Mukhyamantri Vridhjan Tirth Yatra Yojana	Varishth Nagrik Tirth Yatra Yojana
Bhamashah Yojana	Jan Aadhaar Yojana
Parbati-Kalisindh-Chambal ERCP	Ram Jal Setu Link Project (renamed 22 January 2025)

Rajasthan's health insurance chain — the most repeated scheme sequence in the exam



- Chiranjeevi cover ladder: ₹5 lakh (2021) to ₹10 lakh (1 May 2022) to ₹25 lakh (Feb 2023).
- Annual premium ₹850 for the paid category; free for NFSA, SECC-2011 and small and marginal farmers.
- Shree Annapurna Rasoi: meal at ₹8 a plate, state subsidy ₹17, slogan 'Koi Bhookha Na Soye'.
- Lado Protsahan Yojana (1 August 2024): savings bond of ₹1,50,000 in seven instalments up to graduation or age 21.
- Jan Aadhaar: 10-digit family ID, motto 'One Number, One Card, One Identity'; the DBT backbone of the state.

TRAP

Do not mix up the two food schemes. Shree Annapurna Rasoi (formerly Indira Rasoi) is a cooked meal at ₹8 a plate. The Mukhyamantri Nishulk Annapurna Food Packet Yojana (15 August 2023) is a free monthly grocery packet to NFSA families. Similar names, completely different schemes.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2023 asked which scheme runs on the slogan 'Koi Bhookha Na Soye'. The question was disputed because both Indira Rasoi and the Annapurna Food Packet were plausible. The slogan belongs to Indira Rasoi, now Shree Annapurna Rasoi. Learn the slogan-scheme pair exactly.

ASKED IN RAS

Rajasthan's health insurance evolution has been asked in 2016 and 2021, and the chain has changed twice since. Learn all four names in order — this is a ready-made chronological ordering question.

Scheme to principal beneficiary

Scheme	Who it is for
Gopal Credit Card	Cowherds and dairy farmers (gopalaks)
Mukhyamantri Mangla Pashu Bima Yojana	Owners of milch animals — about 21 lakh animals covered
Lado Protsahan Yojana	Girl children
Solar Didi	Women trained in solar equipment
Mukhyamantri Kisan Mitra Urja Yojana	Metered farm electricity consumers — up to ₹1,000 a month
Mukhyamantri Horticulture Mission	Olive, date palm and pomegranate growers in arid districts
Indira Gandhi Shahri Rozgar Guarantee Yojana	Urban households — 125 days of guaranteed work

- *Rajasthan Minimum Guaranteed Income Act, 2023* — Rajasthan was the **FIRST** state to legislate a minimum guaranteed income.
- *Right to Health Act, 2022* — Rajasthan was the **FIRST** state to legislate a right to health.
- *Rajasthan Silicosis Policy 2019* — the **FIRST** dedicated silicosis policy in India.
- *The Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025* (assent 21 December 2025) repeals MGNREGA 2005 and guarantees 125 days of wage employment — this directly changes Rajasthan's largest rural programme.
- *Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0* was approved in March 2026 with a ₹8.69 lakh crore outlay and a December 2028 target.

ASKED IN RAS

Rajasthan's e-governance portals — Jan Aadhaar, RAJ NIVESH, Raj Kaj — have been asked in 2018, 2021 and 2024. Portal-to-purpose is a standing RPSC habit. Women's schemes (Indira Mahila Shakti, Shakti Udaan) came in 2018, 2021 and 2023.

State policies — learn them by year, not by content

Rajasthan has issued a policy for almost every sector. You cannot read them all, and you do not need to. RPSC asks one thing about a policy: which year. Occasionally it asks the sector. That is all. So build a year table and drill it. The pattern of recent years is easy to hold: 2023 was the energy year, 2024 the industry year, 2025 the services and digital year, 2026 the frontier-technology year.

State policies by year — 2023 to 2026

Year	Policies notified
2026	Aerospace & Defence; Semiconductor; Industrial Park Promotion; AI-ML
2025	GCC (Global Capability Centre); Logistics; Textile & Apparel; Data Centre; RIICO Direct Land Allotment; Youth Policy
2024	RIPS; MSME; Export Promotion; Mineral; M-Sand; Integrated Cluster Development; AVGC-XR; Civil Aviation; ODOP; Integrated Clean Energy; Tourism Unit
2023	Green Hydrogen; Renewable Energy; Biomass & Waste to Energy

- Older policies still quoted: EV, Handicraft, Film Tourism, Rural Tourism and Startup all 2022; Ethanol and Ecotourism 2021.
- Tourism Policy 2020; Industrial Development Policy, MSME Act, Silicosis Policy, Solar Energy Policy and Wind & Hybrid Policy all 2019; IT & ITeS Policy 2015.
- M-Sand Policy 2024 — promotes manufactured sand as a substitute for river-bed sand.
- AVGC-XR Policy 2024 — animation, visual effects, gaming, comics and extended reality.
- ODOP Policy 2024 — One District One Product.
- GCC Policy 2025 — global capability centres.
- Integrated Clean Energy Policy 2024 — target 125 GW by 2029-30: 90 GW solar, 25 GW wind and hybrid, 10 GW hydro, pumped and battery storage.
- Green Hydrogen Policy 2023 — target 2,000 KTPA of green hydrogen by 2030.
- In November 2025 the state announced 12 new sectoral policies to be added to the 22 already in operation.

YAAD RAKHO

The single most-missed pair: the Logistics Policy is 2025, NOT 2024.

Everything else in that industrial cluster — MSME, Mineral, M-Sand, Export Promotion, ODOP, AVGC-XR — is 2024. If a 'which is NOT a 2024 policy' question appears, Logistics is the answer.

ASKED IN RAS

Rajasthan's solar and renewable energy policies have been asked in every paper since 2016 — Solar Energy Policy, RRECL as nodal agency, PM-KUSUM, PM Surya Ghar. Never skip the energy policy row. RIICO industrial areas and specialised parks came in 2018, 2021 and 2024; MSME promotion in 2023 and 2024.

Rising Rajasthan — and what actually followed

Rising Rajasthan was the state's global investment summit, held in December 2024 and inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Two numbers matter: what was signed, and what has actually been grounded. RPSC likes the gap between the two, because that is where a 'which statement is correct' question hides.

Rising Rajasthan Global Investment Summit — the headline facts

Item	Figure
Held	December 2024, inaugurated by the Prime Minister
Total MoU value	About ₹35 lakh crore
Energy sector	₹6.19 lakh crore — the largest single share
Industries	₹75,731 crore
Urban development and housing	₹37,824 crore
Mines	₹33,060 crore

Signed versus grounded — the follow-through (as of January 2026)

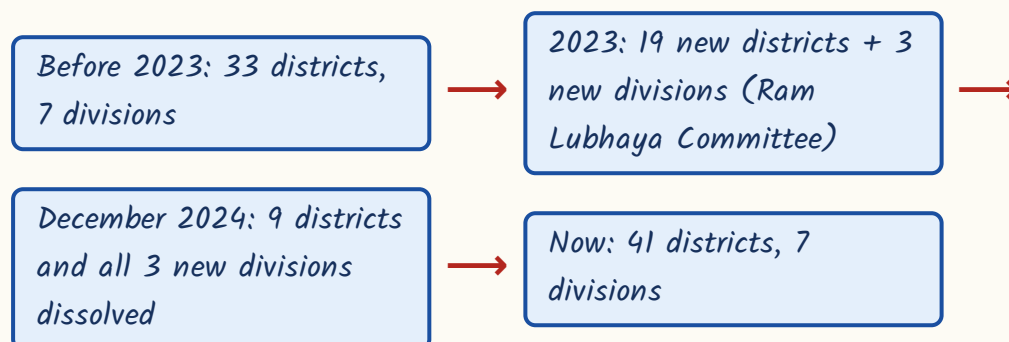
MoUs signed at the summit	Investment actually grounded
About ₹35 lakh crore	About ₹8 lakh crore by January 2026
December 2024	Roughly 23% conversion in the first year
Energy dominated the pledges	Energy also dominates the grounded projects

- The largest sectoral share of MoU value was ENERGY — not mining. This is the standard trap in the summit questions.
- The summit fed directly into the 2025 and 2026 policy wave — GCC, Data Centre, Semiconductor, Aerospace & Defence.
- The state's stated economic goal alongside the summit is a USD 350 billion economy by 2030.

Districts and divisions — the position you must state

This is the most asked administrative fact in recent Rajasthan current affairs, and it is also the one most students still get wrong because they memorised the 2023 position and never updated it. Say it out loud once: forty-one districts, seven divisions. That is the position now. The story runs in two steps. In 2023 the state created 19 new districts and 3 new divisions on the recommendation of a committee headed by Ram Lubhaya. In December 2024 the new government rolled much of it back — 9 of those districts and all 3 new divisions were dissolved.

District reorganisation — the sequence



The two lists you must be able to reproduce

Retained from 2023 (8)	Dissolved in December 2024 (9)
Balotra	Dudu
Beawar	Kekri

Retained from 2023 (8)	Dissolved in December 2024 (9)
Deeg	Shahpura
Didwana-Kuchaman	Neem Ka Thana
Kotputli-Behror	Gangapur City
Khairthal-Tijara	Jaipur Rural
Phalodi	Jodhpur Rural
Salumbar	Anupgarh
—	Sanchore

- The three divisions abolished in December 2024: Pali, Sikar and Banswara.
- The seven surviving divisions: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Udaipur, Bikaner, Bharatpur.
- Bharatpur is the division most often planted as a wrong option in 'which was abolished' questions — it was not.

TRAP

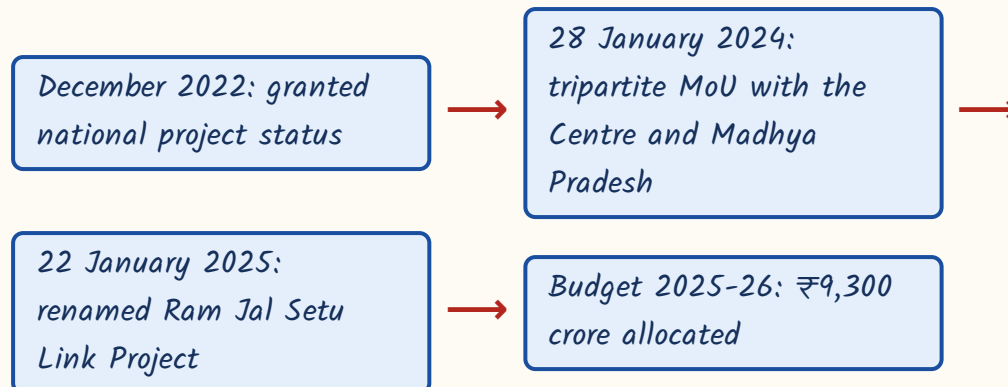
Three ways this is set as a trap. One: the option '50 districts and 10 divisions' — that was never the settled position and is wrong now. Two: Beawar looks new and is often assumed to have been scrapped — it was retained. Three: Bharatpur is offered as an abolished division — it survives. Learn $33 + 8$ retained = 41 and you can never be shaken on the count.

The big projects — water, refinery, energy, metro

Four projects carry almost all the project questions in this chapter. Take them one at a time and learn the identity facts — name, district, capacity, status — rather than the engineering.

Ram Jal Setu Link Project (formerly PKC-ERCP)

Ram Jal Setu — the dates



- Formerly the Parbati-Kalisindh-Chambal Eastern Rajasthan Canal Project; part of the national river interlinking programme.
- Serves 17 eastern districts — the ORIGINAL ERCP was framed as a 13-district project.
- Covers roughly 40% of the state's population for irrigation, drinking and industrial water.
- About 37 sq km of its total 408.86 sq km submergence area falls inside Ranthambore Tiger Reserve.

Pachpadra refinery — HPCL Rajasthan Refinery Ltd

Pachpadra refinery — the identity facts

Item	Detail
Company	HPCL Rajasthan Refinery Limited (HRRL)
Location	Pachpadra, BALOTRA district
Capacity	9 MMTPA refining + 2.4 MMTPA petrochemicals
Equity	HPCL 74%, Government of Rajasthan 26%
Revised cost	About ₹79,459 crore, approved by CCEA in April 2026
Status	Declared commercially operational in June 2026

TRAP

Pachpadra is in BALOTRA district. Balotra was one of the eight new districts retained in December 2024. Older material still says Barmer, and Jalore is offered as a decoy. If an option says Jalore or Barmer, reject it — but be ready for a question phrased 'the Barmer-Sanchore basin', which is the geological basin and is a different thing from the district.

Energy — where Rajasthan actually stands

Solar versus total renewable — the ranking that gets confused (as of March 2026)

Installed solar capacity	Total renewable capacity
Rajasthan is FIRST in India	Rajasthan is SECOND in India
No state ahead	Gujarat is ahead
Bhadla Solar Park, about 2,245 MW, Phalodi district	Wind capacity is where Gujarat pulls ahead

- Rajasthan's total installed generation capacity was 54.77 GW as on 31 October 2025, up from 22.02 GW in March 2020.
- RRECL, Jaipur is the state nodal agency for solar, wind, biomass and green hydrogen.
- Jaipur Metro Phase 1 (Mansarovar-Chandpole) opened 3 June 2015 — the state's first metro.
- Jaipur Metro Phase 2, the Orange Line, runs Ambabari to Prahaladpura/Sitapura — about 42.8 km, 36 stations, fully elevated.
- The Budget 2025-26 committed ₹12,000 crore to Jaipur Metro; as of September 2026 Phase 2 awaits Union Cabinet clearance.

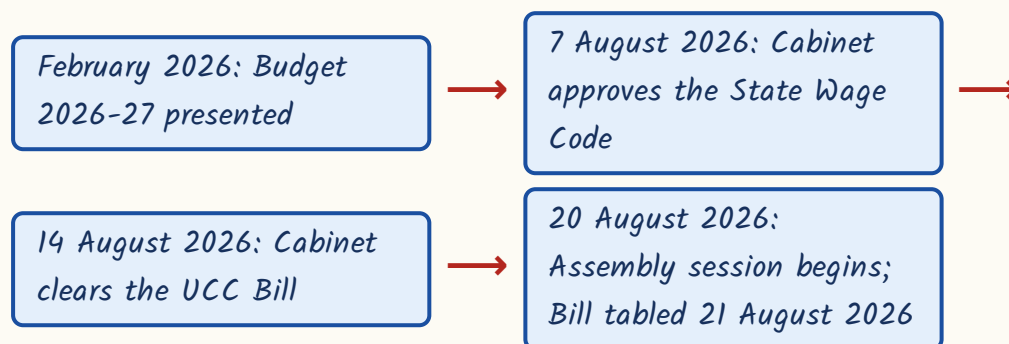
New laws, ordinances and cabinet decisions of 2026

2026 has been a heavy legislative year for the state and this is fresh material — exactly the kind RPSC reaches for. Learn the name, the date and the one distinguishing provision of each.

2026 legislation and cabinet decisions

Item	Key facts
Rajasthan Uniform Civil Code Bill, 2026	Cleared by Cabinet 14 August 2026; drafted on an expert committee headed by Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai; marriage registration within 60 days; Scheduled Tribes exempted
Rajasthan State Wage Code, 2026	Approved 7 August 2026; wages revised twice a year, on 1 April and 1 October; 48-hour working week
Rajasthan Trees (Protection) Bill, 2026	Protection for 29 listed species
One State One Election	Simultaneous elections for panchayati raj institutions and urban local bodies
Agro-Food Processing Policy 2026	Subsidy of 60%, up to ₹50 lakh

The UCC sequence of 2026 — a ready-made ordering question



CURRENT LINK

Status check (as of September 2026): the UCC Bill had been cleared by the Cabinet and tabled in the Assembly, but you must verify before the exam whether it has been passed, referred to a select committee, or received the Governor's assent. Note also the exemption clause — Scheduled Tribes and communities with constitutionally protected traditional rights are outside its scope. The 60-day marriage registration window is the number to remember; 30 days is the planted wrong option.

Appointments to state posts

Appointment questions are pure recall and pure marks. There is no understanding involved — you either know the name or you do not. Learn the office, the name, the month and, where it is given, the service batch, because RPSC has asked for the batch year.

Who holds what (as of September 2026)

Office	Holder	From
Governor	Haribhau Bagde	—
Chief Minister	Bhajan Lal Sharma	—
Deputy Chief Ministers	Diya Kumari (Finance) and Prem Chand Bairwa	—
Chief Secretary	Voruganti Srinivas, IAS 1989	17 November 2025, succeeding Sudhansh Pant
Director General of Police	Rajeev Kumar Sharma, IPS 1990	30 June 2025, fixed two-year tenure, succeeding Ravi Prakash Meharda
Chairman, RPSC	Utkal Ranjan Sahoo, IPS 1988	10 June 2025

- Rajasthan High Court: Justice M.M. Shrivastava was the 42nd Chief Justice, 6 February 2024 to 20 July 2025, then transferred to the Madras High Court.
- Justice K.R. Shriram was sworn in as Chief Justice on 22 July 2025, the oath administered by Governor Haribhau Bagde.
- Chronological order of the 2025 appointments: RPSC Chairman (June 10), DGP (June 30), High Court Chief Justice (July 22), Chief Secretary (November 17).

CURRENT LINK

Verify before the exam (as of early September 2026): the Supreme Court Collegium has recommended a new Chief Justice for the Rajasthan High Court in its latest round, so this chair is in motion. Check the Rajasthan High Court website for the sitting Chief Justice in November 2026 and overwrite this line. Do the same for any commission chairperson vacancies.

Conservation decisions — Ramsar sites and tiger reserves

These are government decisions, which is why they sit in this chapter as well as in geography. Two counts, both changed recently: five Ramsar sites and five notified tiger reserves. Learn the counts and the newest additions.

Rajasthan's five Ramsar sites

Site	District	Year
Keoladeo Ghana National Park	Bharatpur	1981
Sambhar Lake	Jaipur and Nagaur	1990
Menar	Udaipur	5 June 2025
Khichan	Phalodi	5 June 2025
Siliserh Lake	Alwar	2025

- Khichan and Menar were designated on 5 June 2025, World Environment Day; India's national tally rose to 91, the highest in Asia.
- Khichan is famous as a wintering ground for the demoiselle crane (kurjan).
- Rajasthan's five notified tiger reserves: Ranthambore, Sariska, Mukundra Hills (2013), Ramgarh Vishdhari (2022, Bundi) and Dholpur-Karauli (2023).
- Dholpur-Karauli is India's 54th tiger reserve and Rajasthan's newest.
- The proposed sixth is Kumbhalgarh-Todgarh Raoli, about 1,397 sq km, in-principle approval August 2023.

TRAP

Kumbhalgarh-Todgarh Raoli spans Rajsamand, Udaipur, Pali, Ajmer and Sirohi. Bhilwara is the standard wrong option — it is NOT part of the proposed reserve. And on Ramsar, Nalsarovar is Gujarat's, not Rajasthan's; it appears in every 'which is NOT a Rajasthan Ramsar site' question.

REVISION RECAP

1. Budget 2026-27: February 2026, Diya Kumari, theme Viksit Rajasthan @2047, outlay about ₹6,10,956 crore.
2. Budget 2026-27 numbers: GSDP ₹21,52,100 crore; fiscal deficit 3.69%; no new tax; 1 lakh government jobs.
3. Thematic outlays 2026-27: Agriculture ₹1,19,408 cr, Gender ₹74,312 cr, Child ₹51,138 cr, Green ₹33,475 cr.
4. Name to purpose: RAJ-SURAKSHA emergency medicine, RAJ-MAMTA mental health, RAJ-SETU urban infra, Raj-PAHAL School on Wheels.
5. PRITHWI is wildlife habitat (about ₹1,500 cr); Raj-AIMS is the Digital Agriculture Mission; Mission Raj GIFT is GI tagging.
6. ₹32,000 crore Yamuna project is for Shekhawati — Jhunjhunu, Churu, Sikar; solar parks about 4,630 MW.
7. Budget 2025-26: 19 February 2025, first green theme budget, fiscal deficit 4.25%, USD 350 billion economy by 2030.
8. 2025-26 flagships: Ram Jal Setu ₹9,300 cr, nine expressways ₹60,000 cr, Jaipur Metro ₹12,000 cr, 150 free units.
9. Health insurance chain: Bhamashah 2016, Ayushman Bharat MGRSBY 2019, Chiranjeevi 2021, Mukhyamantri Ayushman Arogya Yojana 2024.

10. Indira Rasoi became Shree Annapurna Rasoi on 5 January 2024; slogan 'Koi Bhookha Na Soye', ₹8 a plate.
11. Policy years: 2023 energy, 2024 industry, 2025 services and digital, 2026 frontier technology. Logistics is 2025, not 2024.
12. Rising Rajasthan: December 2024, PM Modi, MoUs about ₹35 lakh crore, energy the largest share at ₹6.19 lakh crore.
13. About ₹8 lakh crore of the Rising Rajasthan MoUs had been grounded by January 2026.
14. Districts: 33 before 2023, 19 created in 2023 (Ram Lubhaya Committee), 9 plus 3 divisions dissolved December 2024, now 41 and 7.
15. The eight retained districts: Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Kotputli-Behror, Khairthal-Tijara, Phalodi, Salumbar.
16. Ram Jal Setu, renamed 22 January 2025 from PKC-ERCP, serves 17 eastern districts; the old ERCP was 13.
17. Pachpadra refinery: HRRL, Balotra district, 9 + 2.4 MMTPA, HPCL 74 / Rajasthan 26, about ₹79,459 crore, operational June 2026.
18. Energy rank: first in installed solar, second overall in renewables behind Gujarat, as of March 2026.
19. 2026 laws: UCC Bill cleared 14 August (Desai committee, 60-day registration, ST exemption); Wage Code 7 August (48-hour week).
20. Office-holders: Governor Bagde, CS Voruganti Srinivas (Nov 2025), DGP Rajeev Kumar Sharma (June 2025), RPSC Chairman Utkal Ranjan Sahoo (June 2025).

CA02

Rajasthan: Awards, Events, Sports, Personalities,

Places

About 4-6 questions inside the ~21-question current affairs block. The facts change every year; the categories never do. Content window here is roughly September 2025 to September 2026, compiled as of September 2026.

This is the 'Rajasthan in the news' chapter — awards won, places listed, matches won, people appointed. RPSC builds four to six questions a paper out of it, and the pattern of what it picks has been the same for a decade: a literary award (usually Sahitya Akademi in Rajasthani), a Rajasthani sportsperson, a new listing or a new first for the state.

Rajasthan in the News (Sept 2025 - Sept 2026)

Awards

- Sahitya Akademi 2025 - Rajasthani: Jitender Kumar Soni
- Padma 2026 - Taga Ram Bheel, Gafruddin Mewati Jogi
- Republic Day tableau 3rd (Popular Choice)
- GI tag: Jodhpuri Mozri

People

- Rajeshwar Singh - State Election Commissioner
- Justice Sanjay K. Agarwal - CJ, Rajasthan HC (recommended)
- Justice Ranjana P. Desai - UCC committee
- Diya Kumari - Budget 2026-27

Places & listings

- 5 Ramsar sites (Menar, Khichan, Siliserh added 2025)
- 5 notified tiger reserves; Kumbhalgarh proposed
- Renamings: Abu Raj, Kamvan, Yajnpur
- Six eco-cities

Events & firsts

- Exercise Agni Varsha, Pokhran
- Vibrant Villages Ph-II, 184 villages
- First state with rare-earth exploration licence
- Pachpadra refinery dedicated (Balotra)

Sports

- Arundhati Choudhary (Kota)
- CWG 2026 boxing GOLD
- Yashvir Singh - javelin bronze
- Sth Khelo India University Games, Jaipur
- Tour de Thar, Bikaner

What this chapter is, and how RPSC actually asks it

Everything here happened in the last eighteen months or so. There is no textbook for it. RPSC's paper-setters build these questions from state press releases, Rajasthan Sujas and newspaper headlines — which is why Rajasthan current affairs is rated the hardest bucket in the paper every single year. But hard does not mean unpredictable. The categories repeat exactly.

- A literary award question — most often Sahitya Akademi in the Rajasthani language.
- A sports question with at least one Rajasthani athlete in it.
- A 'new listing' question — Ramsar site, tiger reserve, GI tag, heritage status.
- An appointment or a personality — who holds which state post now.
- A 'first for Rajasthan' — first state to do X, first policy of its kind.
- So study by category, not by date: learn the Ramsar five as a set, the award winners as a table.
- Everything here is stated as of September 2026 — refresh the volatile items in November 2026.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH shows two hard patterns: the Sahitya Akademi award in Rajasthani was asked in RAS Pre 2018 AND again in 2023, and every single paper carries a sports block of 4-6 questions containing at least one Rajasthani athlete. Treat both as guaranteed.

Sahitya Akademi and the literary awards — the documented repeat

Start with the Sahitya Akademi. It is the national academy of letters, and it gives an annual award in 24 Indian languages — Rajasthani is one of them. Each award is Rs 1,00,000 with an engraved copper plaque. The 2025 awards were announced on 16 March 2026 and presented on 31 March 2026 in New Delhi. This is the single most examinable item in the chapter.

The Rajasthani award — learn the last decade as a table

Sahitya Akademi Award in Rajasthani, 2015-2025

Year	Author	Work
2025	Jitender Kumar Soni	Bharkhama (short stories)
2024	Mukut Maniraj	Gaon Ar Amma
2023	Gaje Singh Rajpurohit	Palakati Preet
2022	Kamal Ranga	Alekhun Amba
2021	Meethesh Nirmohi	Mugtee
2020	Bhanwar Singh Samaur	Sanskriti ri Sanatana Deeth
2019	Ramswaroop Kisan	Barik Baat
2018	Rajesh Kumar Vyas	Kavita Devai Deeth
2017	Neeraj Daiya	Bina Hasalpai
2016	Bulaki Sharma	Murdjat Ar Dujee Kahaniyan
2015	Madhu Acharya 'Ashawadi'	Gawaad

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in RAS Pre 2023 — the Sahitya Akademi award in the Rajasthani language. For 2026, the answer to know cold is Jitender Kumar Soni for 'Bharkhama', a short-story collection (award for 2025, announced March 2026).

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the last four in order, backwards from the newest: So-Ma-Ra-Ra — Soni (2025), Maniraj (2024), Rajpurohit (2023), Ranga (2022). And remember the genre with the name: Bharkhama = kahaniyan (short stories), not poetry.

Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025 — announced 16 March 2026

Language	Awardee	Work / form
Hindi	Mamta Kalia	Jeete Jee Allahabad (memoir)
English	Navtej Sarna	Crimson Spring (novel)
Rajasthani	Jitender Kumar Soni	Bharkhama (short stories)
Urdu	Pritpal Singh Betab	Safar Jaari Hai
Punjabi	Jinder	Safety Kit
Sanskrit	Sadhu Bhadreshdas	-

Now the state layer. Rajasthani as a language has its own state academy — the Rajasthani Bhasha, Sahitya evam Sanskriti Akademi at Bikaner. Its top honour is the Suryamal Mishran Shikhar Award, named after the 19th-century poet-historian of Bundi, carrying Rs 71,000. It has run since 1985, and the first recipient was Shakti Dan Kaviya. Do not mix this state award up with the national Sahitya Akademi award — RPSC likes exactly this kind of near-miss pair.

National vs state literary honour

Sahitya Akademi Award	Suryamal Mishran Shikhar Award
Sahitya Akademi, New Delhi (national academy)	Rajasthani Bhasha, Sahitya evam Sanskriti Akademi, Bikaner
24 languages, Rajasthani one of them	Rajasthani language only
Rs 1,00,000 + plaque	Rs 71,000
2025 award: Jitender Kumar Soni	Instituted 1985; first awardee Shakti Dan Kaviya

- Rajasthan Ratna is the state's highest civilian honour, on the Bharat Ratna model — Rs 1 lakh, shawl and citation.
- Its recipients include Allah Jilai Bai, Kanhaiyalal Sethia, Vijaydan Detha, Komal Kothari and Pt. Vishwa Mohan Bhatt.
- Most Rajasthan Ratna awards have been posthumous — a favourite statement-question trick.

Padma Awards 2026 and the Rajasthanis in the list

Padma awards are announced on the eve of Republic Day and conferred at Rashtrapati Bhavan later in the year. Three grades, in descending order: Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, Padma Shri. On 25 January 2026 the government announced 131 awards — 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and the rest Padma Shri. 54 of the awardees were described as 'unsung heroes'. Learn the total, the split and the Rajasthan names.

Padma Vibhushan 2026 — all five

Name	Field	Note
Dharmendra	Art	Posthumous
V.S. Achuthanandan	Public Affairs	Posthumous
K.T. Thomas	Public Affairs	-
N. Rajam	Art	Violinist

Name	Field	Note
P. Narayanan	Literature and Education	-

- Padma Shri 2026 from Rajasthan: Gafruddin Mewati Jogi (Art) and Taga Ram Bheel (Art) — both in Art.
- Padma Bhushan 2026 names worth knowing: Alka Yagnik (Art), Mammootty (Art), Uday Kotak (Trade and Industry), Vijay Amritraj (Sports).
- Mammootty's field is Art, not Sports — the classic 'which pair is NOT correctly matched' bait.
- Two of the five Padma Vibhushan awards in 2026 were posthumous.

State honours, the tableau, GI tags and heritage

Rajasthan's Republic Day tableau is asked almost as often as the Padma list, because it packages a theme and a rank in one line. In 2026 the tableau was titled 'Desert's Golden Touch' (Registan ka Sunahra Sparsh), it was themed on the Usta art of Bikaner — the gold-embossed camel-hide craft — and it took third place in the Popular Choice category, announced 30 January 2026.

- 44th India International Trade Fair (November 2025, New Delhi): Rajasthan won GOLD in the Partner State category.
- Outlook Traveller Awards 2025: Udaipur named 'Best Wedding Destination'.
- PMFBY Kharif 2025: Rajasthan ranked FIRST in India in farmer enrolment.
- National Tobacco Control Programme 2024-25: best-performance award to Rajasthan.
- GI tag July 2026: Jodhpuri Mozri, the roughly 200-year-old footwear craft; Kota Doria, Bagru and Sanganeri prints were tagged much earlier.
- The Walled City of Jaipur was inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List in 2019 — not 2026.

CURRENT LINK

Live issue as of September 2026: UNESCO has asked Rajasthan for a conservation report on the Walled City of Jaipur by December 2026. If a status change is reported before the exam, it will make a question — check this in November 2026.

Places in the news — Ramsar sites, tiger reserves and renamed places

A Ramsar site is a wetland of international importance designated under the Ramsar Convention of 1971. India's tally has been climbing fast, and Rajasthan jumped from two sites to five in a single year. This is the highest-probability 'new listing' question in the chapter.

Rajasthan's FIVE Ramsar sites (as of September 2026)

Site	District	Designated
Keoladeo Ghana National Park	Bharatpur	1981
Sambhar Lake	Jaipur and Nagaur	1990
Menar wetland	Udaipur	2025
Khichan	Phalodi	2025
Siliserh Lake	Alwar	2025

- Khichan is the Demoiselle crane (Kurjan) village — thousands winter there every year.
- Menar is called the 'Bird Village' — its listing came from community-led conservation.
- Menar and Khichan were designated on World Environment Day, June 2025, taking India's tally to 91 — then the highest in Asia.

- Sambhar Lake is India's largest inland saline lake; it lies across TWO districts, Jaipur and Nagaur.
- India's 99th Ramsar site: Shekha Lake, Aligarh (April 2026). The 100th: Jay Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary, Ballia, UP (5 June 2026).

YAAD RAKHO

Five sites, remember them as two old and three new: KE-SA (Keoladeo 1981, Sambhar 1990) then ME-KHI-SI (Menar, Khichan, Siliserh — all 2025). Old ones are national-park and salt-lake; new ones are bird wetlands.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2016 and 2023 both asked about Keoladeo and Sambhar as Ramsar sites. With three new additions in 2025 the natural 2026 question is the total — the answer is five, and Siliserh (Alwar) is the one candidates forget.

Now the tiger reserves. Rajasthan has FIVE notified tiger reserves. A sixth is proposed but not yet notified, and that gap is exactly where RPSC sets its trap. Learn the five with their districts, and learn the sixth as 'proposed'.

Notified tiger reserves of Rajasthan

Tiger reserve	District(s)	Notified
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	1973-74 (Project Tiger's first batch)
Sariska	Alwar	1978-79
Mukundra Hills	Kota, Chittorgarh, Jhalawar, Bundi	2013
Ramgarh Vishdhari	Bundi	2022

Tiger reserve	District(s)	Notified
Dholpur-Karauli	Dholpur and Karauli	2023

TRAP

Kumbhalgarh is only PROPOSED, not notified. The proposal joins Kumbhalgarh with Todgarh-Raoli, about 1,397 sq km across Rajsamand, Udaipur, Pali, Ajmer and Sirohi; the NTCA gave in-principle approval in August 2023 and it was still pending as of September 2026. If an option says Rajasthan has six tiger reserves, it is wrong. Two more reserve facts to carry: Sariska completed 18 years of tiger reintroduction in 2026, and the first inter-state translocation involving Rajasthan was planned from Pench (MP) to Ramgarh Vishdhari, Bundi.

Renamings of 27 February 2026

Three places renamed

Old name	New name
Mount Abu	Abu Raj
Kaman	Kamvan
Jahazpur	Yajnpur

TRAP

Do not cross-match the renamings. Mount Abu became ABU RAJ, not Kamvan. Kaman became Kamvan. Jahazpur became Yajnpur. RPSC's standard trick here is to swap two of the three in a 'NOT correctly matched' question.

Conservation and environment stories from the state

The Great Indian Bustard (Godawan) is Rajasthan's state bird and India's most closely watched breeding programme. As of March 2026 the captive population had reached 73 birds. The headline event was 'Operation Egg Transfer' — a fertilised egg was carried 770 km from the Sam centre in Jaisalmer to Kutch in Gujarat in 19 hours, and the chick hatched there after a gap of a decade.

- Careful: the chick was born in KUTCH, Gujarat, not in Rajasthan — the egg travelled out, the hatching happened outside. Statement questions are built on exactly this.
- February 2026: statewide ban on felling of the KHEJRI, the state tree, after an 11-day Bishnoi community agitation.
- The khejri ban sits in a long tradition — Khejarli 1730, Amrita Devi and the Bishnoi sacrifice for the same tree.
- October 2025: six eco-cities approved — Mandawa, Khatu Shyamji, Bhiwadi, Alwar, Bikaner and Bharatpur. Pushkar is NOT one of them.
- 'Developed Rajasthan @2047' sets a \$4.3 trillion economy target for the state.

CURRENT LINK

Watch this one: on 30 December 2025 the Supreme Court suspended the 100-metre height criterion used to classify the Aravallis and ordered a high-level expert committee covering Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi-NCR. The committee's definition, whenever it lands, changes what counts as protected Aravalli land in Rajasthan. Status as of September 2026 — pending.

Sports — the Rajasthani athlete question

Every RAS paper carries a sports block, and at least one question in it is about a Rajasthani. For 2026 the name to know before any other is Arundhati

Choudhary.

- ARUNDHATI CHOUDHARY of KOTA won GOLD in women's 70 kg BOXING at the Commonwealth Games 2026.
- She beat England's Chantelle Reid by a 5-0 unanimous decision.
- Yashvir Singh won BRONZE in the men's javelin throw at the same Games; Neeraj Chopra took silver — an India 1-2 finish.
- Chief Minister Bhajanlal Sharma felicitated the state's CWG 2026 medallists with cash awards.
- Uma Chaudhary (CISF) won gold in javelin at the World Police and Fire Games 2025, Birmingham.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH cluster 84: a sports block of 4-6 questions appears in every paper and always includes at least one Rajasthani athlete. Arundhati Choudhary — Kota, boxing, 70 kg, gold, CWG 2026 — is the highest-probability single name in this whole chapter after the Sahitya Akademi winner.

Events in the state, 2025

Event	Where	Detail
5th Khelo India University Games 2025	Opened at Sawai Mansingh Stadium, Jaipur	Across 7 Rajasthan cities; 4,448 athletes from 222 universities
Tour de Thar 2025 (23 Nov 2025)	Bikaner	India's FIRST desert cycling rally
Cognivera International Polo Cup 2025	Jaipur Polo Ground	India beat Argentina 10-9

- State sports honours to know by name: the Maharana Pratap Award for players and the Guru Vashishtha Award for coaches.

- A 5 per cent GST on the horse trade was levied for the first time at the PUSHKAR Fair in 2025 — not at the Nagaur cattle fair.

Personalities and appointments

Appointment questions are pure recall, so keep them in one table and revise the table, not the news stories. Positions below are as of September 2026. Note the link to your polity notes: the State Election Commissioner is a state constitutional post under Article 243K, and the UCC drafting committee is headed by a retired Supreme Court judge.

Who holds what in Rajasthan (as of September 2026)

Person	Position	When
Bhajanlal Sharma	Chief Minister	-
Diya Kumari	Deputy Chief Minister and Finance Minister	Presented Budget 2026-27 on 11 Feb 2026
Rajeshwar Singh (ret'd IAS)	State Election Commissioner	September 2025, succeeding Madhukar Gupta
Justice Sanjay K. Agarwal	Recommended as Chief Justice, Rajasthan High Court	Collegium recommendation, 31 Aug 2026
Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai	Chairperson, Rajasthan UCC drafting committee	June 2026

CURRENT LINK

Volatile as of September 2026: Justice Sanjay K. Agarwal was only at the recommendation stage for Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court on 31 August 2026. Re-verify whether the warrant of appointment was issued before you sit the paper in December 2026.

Events, summits, projects and firsts for the state

Rajasthan hosted or launched a long list of national events in this window. Group them by 'what kind of event' and the district — RPSC's matching questions pair the event with the place.

National events held in / launched from Rajasthan

Event	Place	Date
Rajasthan DigiFest with TiE Global Summit 2026	JECC, Jaipur	4-6 Jan 2026
Exercise AGNI VARSHA 2026 (Army, integrated desert warfare)	Pokhran (Jaisalmer district)	27 Feb 2026
National HPV vaccination campaign launched by the PM	Ajmer	28 Feb 2026
Vibrant Villages Programme Phase-II launched by Amit Shah	Border districts	26 May 2026
National workshop on tiger rehabilitation	Alwar	28 Jun 2026

- Vibrant Villages Phase-II covers 184 border villages of Rajasthan at about Rs 3 crore per village per year.
- District split of those villages: Sri Ganganagar 68, Bikaner 46, Barmer 36, Jaisalmer 30, Phalodi 4.
- Mahi-Banswara Rajasthan Atomic Power Project (2,800 MW): foundation stone by PM Modi at Banswara, 25 September 2025.
- HPCL's Pachpadra refinery was dedicated to the nation in July 2026.
- Bandikui-Jaipur greenfield expressway and projects worth about Rs 17,000 crore launched from Ajmer, 28 February 2026.
- Budget 2026-27 headline numbers: about Rs 6.11 lakh crore, 1 lakh jobs, 42,000 km of roads, Rs 6,800 crore for tap water, Rs 3,000 crore for solar parks.

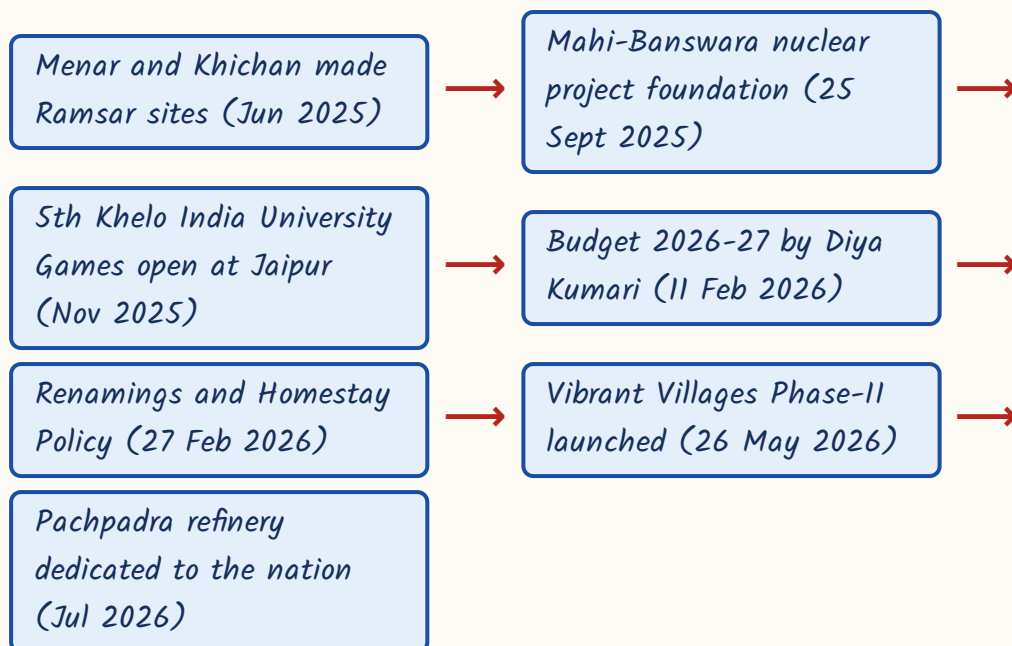
- *Nai Kiran Nasha Mukti Yojana launched 29 March 2026 — de-addiction and rehabilitation, aligned to Nasha Mukti Bharat Abhiyaan.*

TRAP

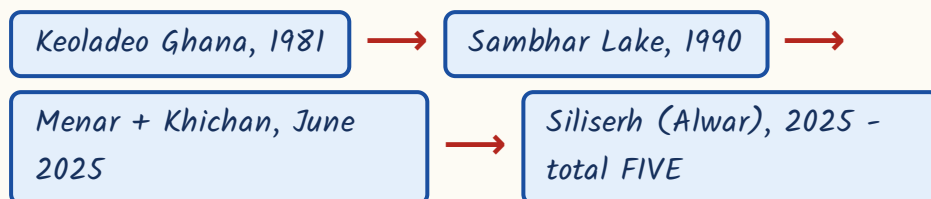
The Pachpadra refinery is in BALOTRA district, not Barmer. Balotra was carved out of Barmer in 2023 and survived the December 2024 district reorganisation. Old study material still says Barmer — in a 2026 paper, Balotra is the answer.

- *July 2026: Rajasthan became the FIRST state to operationalise a rare-earth-element exploration licence — Balotra-Jodhpur block, 207.63 sq km.*
- *First state to adopt the Centre's PRAGATI-style project review platform, named 'Raj-Unnati' (projects worth about Rs 1,943 crore across five departments).*
- *Rajasthan's FIRST Semiconductor Policy 2026 (cabinet, 21 Jan 2026) — Jodhpur-Pali-Marwar corridor as priority zone, capital subsidy up to 60 per cent under the India Semiconductor Mission.*
- *PM-KUSUM: Rajasthan crossed 2,000 MW, Jodhpur DISCOM leading, about 2.83 lakh farmers benefited.*
- *Homestay Policy 2026 (27 Feb 2026): room limit raised from 5 to 8 and the owner-residency condition removed.*
- *Industrial Park Promotion Policy 2026 works through the Raj Nivesh single-window investment portal.*
- *February 2026 also brought two administrative decisions: the two-child norm for panchayat and municipal elections was abolished, and the Revenue Intelligence and Economic Crime Directorate (RRIED) was created.*

The 2025-26 Rajasthan timeline in the order RPSC asks it



How Rajasthan's Ramsar count grew



REVISION RECAP

1. Sahitya Akademi 2025, Rajasthani: Jitender Kumar Soni, 'Bharkhama', short stories — announced 16 Mar 2026, presented 31 Mar 2026, 24 languages, Rs 1 lakh each.
2. Previous Rajasthani winners, newest first: Mukut Maniraj (2024), Gaje Singh Rajpurohit (2023), Kamal Ranga (2022), Meethesh Nirmohi (2021).
3. Suryamal Mishran Shikhar Award = Rajasthani Bhasha, Sahitya evam Sanskriti Akademi, Bikaner; Rs 71,000; since 1985; first awardee Shakti Dan Kaviya.
4. Rajasthan Ratna = state's highest civilian honour; recipients include Allah Jilai Bai, Kanhaiyalal Sethia, Vijaydan Detha, Komal Kothari, Vishwa Mohan Bhatt.
5. Padma 2026: 131 awards on 25 Jan 2026 — 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, rest Shri, 54 'unsung heroes'.
6. Padma Shri 2026 from Rajasthan: Gafuruddin Mewati Jogi and Taga Ram Bheel, both in Art.
7. Republic Day 2026 tableau: 'Desert's Golden Touch', theme Usta art of Bikaner, third in Popular Choice.

8. Five Ramsar sites: Keoladeo 1981, Sambhar 1990, Menar 2025, Khichan 2025, Siliserh (Alwar) 2025.
9. Khichan = Demoiselle cranes; Menar = Bird Village; Sambhar straddles Jaipur and Nagaur.
10. India's 99th Ramsar site Shekha Lake (Aligarh, Apr 2026); 100th Jay Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Ballia, 5 Jun 2026).
11. Five notified tiger reserves — Ranthambore, Sariska, Mukundra Hills, Ramgarh Vishdhari, Dholpur-Karauli. Kumbhalgarh only proposed.
12. Renamed 27 Feb 2026: Mount Abu to Abu Raj, Kaman to Kamvan, Jahazpur to Yajnpur.
13. GIB captive population 73 (Mar 2026); Operation Egg Transfer — Sam (Jaisalmer) to Kutch, 770 km in 19 hours, chick hatched in Gujarat.
14. Khejri felling banned statewide, Feb 2026, after an 11-day Bishnoi agitation.
15. Arundhati Choudhary, Kota — gold, women's 70 kg boxing, CWG 2026, beat Chantelle Reid 5-0; Yashvir Singh javelin bronze behind Neeraj Chopra's silver.
16. 5th Khelo India University Games opened at SMS Stadium Jaipur — 7 cities, 4,448 athletes, 222 universities.
17. Tour de Thar 2025 (Bikaner) = India's first desert cycling rally; Cognivera Polo Cup — India beat Argentina 10-9 at Jaipur.
18. Rajeshwar Singh = State Election Commissioner (Sept 2025); Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai heads the UCC drafting committee (Jun 2026).
19. Firsts: rare-earth exploration licence (Balotra-Jodhpur, Jul 2026), Raj-Unnati PRAGATI-style platform, Semiconductor Policy 2026.
20. Pachpadra refinery is in BALOTRA district; Exercise Agni Varsha 2026 was at Pokhran, Jaisalmer district.

CA03

National Affairs: Polity, Governance and Schemes

Roughly 6-8 questions inside the ~21-question current affairs block, plus a spillover into Indian Polity. Content window September 2025 to September 2026, stated as of September 2026.

The national half of the current affairs block — who holds which office, what Parliament passed, what the Supreme Court held, which scheme got money and where India stands in the global index tables. In 2025-26 this chapter carries an unusually heavy load, because two things happened that RAS-type papers cannot ignore: MGNREGA was repealed and replaced, and the Supreme Court's sanctioned strength went up.

National Affairs (Sept 2025 - Sept 2026)

Who is who

- CJI Surya Kant (53rd)
- CEC Gyanesh Kumar
- CAG K. Sanjay Murthy
- RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra

Supreme Court

- Adoptive mothers - 12 weeks leave
- SC status limited to Hindu/Sikh/Buddhist
- Aravalli 100 m criterion suspended

Big laws

- VB-G RAM G Act 2025 replaces MGNREGA
- Nuclear Energy Act 2025
- SC (Number of Judges) Amendment 2026 - 34 to 38
- Jan Vishwas 2026 - 80 Acts

Schemes

- BHAVYA Rasayan - chemical parks
- GOBARdhan - compressed biogas
- Jal Jeevan Mission to Dec 2028
- PMGSY-III to Mar 2028

Constitution & census

- 131st Amendment Bill DEFEATED 16 Apr 2026
- Delimitation and women's reservation
- Census 2027 - first digital census
- Caste enumeration in Phase II

Elections & indices

- Counting 4 May 2026 - WB, TN, Kerala, Assam, Puducherry
- Happiness 116th
- HDI 130th
- GII 38th

Who holds which office — learn this as a table, revise it weekly

Every paper has one or two 'who is the present X' questions, and they are free marks if you keep a table. Two rules. One, learn the office WITH its constitutional or statutory basis — RPSC often asks the article rather than the name. Two, treat every name here as dated: all positions below are as of September 2026, and offices change with retirements.

Constitutional and high offices (as of September 2026)

Office	Incumbent	Basis
President of India	Droupadi Murmu	Article 52-62
Vice-President of India	C.P. Radhakrishnan	Ex officio Chairman, Rajya Sabha (Art. 64)
Chief Justice of India	Justice Surya Kant (53rd CJI)	Article 124
Chief Election Commissioner	Gyanesh Kumar	Article 324; CEC and ECs Act, 2023
Comptroller and Auditor General	K. Sanjay Murthy	Article 148
Speaker, Lok Sabha	Om Birla	Article 93
Chairman, UPSC	Ajay Kumar	Article 315
Chairperson, NHRC	Justice V. Ramasubramanian	Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

Law officers, economic and scientific heads (as of September 2026)

Office	Incumbent
Attorney General for India	R. Venkataramani
Solicitor General of India	Tushar Mehta
Cabinet Secretary	T.V. Somanathan
National Security Adviser	Ajit Doval

Office	Incumbent
Chief Economic Adviser	V. Anantha Nageswaran
Governor, Reserve Bank of India	Sanjay Malhotra
Chairman, SEBI	Tuhin Kanta Pandey
Chairman, ISRO	Dr V. Narayanan

- RBI Deputy Governors include Poonam Gupta and Shirish Chandra Murmu, appointed September 2025 in place of M. Rajeshwar Rao.
- The CEC and Election Commissioners are appointed under the 2023 Act by a committee of the PM, a Union Minister and the Leader of the Opposition.
- The CAG is appointed under Article 148 and can be removed only in the manner of a Supreme Court judge.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH clusters 17 and 22: the CAG's appointment and removal articles were asked in 2018, 2021 and 2023; the Election Commission in 2023 and 2024; the CVC in 2018 and 2024. The current-affairs version of this is the incumbent's name. Learn name + article together and you cover both papers.

CURRENT LINK

Most volatile part of this chapter, as of September 2026: office-holders. The CJI, the CEC, service chiefs and commission chairpersons can all change before 6 December 2026. Re-verify this table in November 2026 and change nothing else.

The three sessions of Parliament — the skeleton of the year

Hang everything legislative on three pegs: Winter 2025, Budget 2026 and Monsoon 2026. If you know which law belongs to which session, chronology

questions and 'which was NOT passed' questions both collapse.

The legislative year at a glance

Winter Session: 1-19 Dec 2025, 15 sittings, 9 introduced / 7 passed / 2 referred

Budget Session: 28 Jan - 18 Apr 2026, 6 Bills passed, 131st Amendment Bill defeated 16 Apr

Monsoon Session: 20 Jul - 13 Aug 2026, 12 introduced / 11 passed

- Winter 2025: the two Bills referred to committees were the Securities Markets Code, 2025 and the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025.
- Monsoon 2026 productivity was poor — the Lok Sabha functioned about 15 per cent and the Rajya Sabha about 33 per cent of scheduled time.
- Monsoon 2026: the Indian Statistical Institute Bill, 2026 was introduced and referred to a standing committee — it was NOT passed.

Winter Session 2025 — MGNREGA replaced, and the other laws

This is the change you must be able to state in one clean sentence. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 was repealed and replaced by the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 — short form VB-G RAM G. It was introduced in the Lok Sabha on 16 December 2025, passed by both Houses on 18 December 2025, and received the President's assent on 21 December 2025.

MGNREGA, 2005 vs VB-G RAM G Act, 2025

MGNREGA, 2005	VB-G RAM G Act, 2025
100 days of guaranteed wage employment per rural household per year	125 days guaranteed
Centre bore the bulk of wage cost, states a smaller share	Centrally sponsored on a 60:40 basis (Centre:State) for general states
Uniform pattern across states	90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan states
Programme run as an employment guarantee scheme	Run as a Mission, with national and state steering committees
No statutory pause for the farm season	States must notify up to 60 days a year when works pause for peak agriculture

- The statutory right to work survives — it is enlarged to 125 days, not abolished.
- Unemployment allowance is retained: the state must pay if work is not given within 15 days of demand.
- Gram panchayat planning is organised around four themes — water security, rural infrastructure, livelihood support and mitigation of extreme weather.
- Delivery uses biometric authentication, geospatial mapping, mobile dashboards and weekly public disclosure.

TRAP

Three numbers RPSC will play with: it is 125 days (not 100, not 150), the funding is 60:40 (not 75:25, not 90:10 for general states), and the assent date is 21 December 2025. And a statement saying the Act 'abolished the statutory right to work' is FALSE.

Four more laws from the same session are examinable, and each is a one-line fact. Learn what each one replaced or changed — that is the shape of the question.

- *Nuclear Energy Act, 2025* — replaced the Atomic Energy Act, 1962 and permits private-sector participation in nuclear power generation and fuel handling.
- *Insurance Laws (Amendment), 2025* — FDI in insurance raised to 100 per cent; net-owned-fund requirement for foreign re-insurers cut from Rs 5,000 crore to Rs 1,000 crore.
- *Repealing and Amending Act, 2025* — repealed 71 obsolete laws.
- *Securities Markets Code, 2025* (referred to committee) — would consolidate the SEBI Act, the Depositories Act and the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act.
- *Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025* (referred to committee) — a single higher-education regulator replacing the UGC, AICTE and NCTE.

TRAP

The Nuclear Energy Act, 2025 replaced the ATOMIC ENERGY ACT, 1962 — not the Electricity Act, 2003. A distractor option offering the Electricity Act appeared in the practice set and it is exactly what a paper-setter writes.

Budget Session and Monsoon Session 2026 — the new statute book

Six Bills were passed in the Budget Session and eleven in the Monsoon Session. You do not need all seventeen. You need the ones with a distinctive subject, because matching questions pair the Bill's name with what it does.

Budget Session 2026 — the six laws

Law	What it does
Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions), 2026	Decriminalises or rationalises offences across 80 central Acts

Law	What it does
Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration), 2026	50% of IG posts and 67% of ADG posts by IPS deputation
Industrial Relations Code (Amendment)	Labour law amendment
Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment	Rights of transgender persons
Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (Amendment)	Insolvency process
Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment)	Reorganisation provisions

Monsoon Session 2026 — the laws that carry a fact

Law	Key point
Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment, 2026	Sanctioned strength raised from 34 to 38
Tribunals Reforms, 2026	Establishes a National Tribunals Commission
Kerala (Alteration of Name), 2026	Renames the state 'Keralam'
Bankers' Books Evidence, 2026	Digital banking records admissible as legal evidence
MSME Development (Amendment), 2026	Mediation in delayed-payment disputes within 90 days
Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment	Exam-integrity law tightened
Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment)	National honour offences
Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment)	Civil registration
MMDR (Amendment), 2026	Centre's power over mineral-bearing lands
Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) / NCDC (Amendment)	Tax and co-operative development

Take the first row seriously. The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956 fixed the number of judges other than the Chief Justice; the 2026 Amendment changed that figure from 33 to 37, which means a total sanctioned strength of 38 including the CJI. An ordinance came first, on 17 May 2026; the Lok Sabha cleared the Bill on 3 August 2026 and the President assented on 12 August 2026. The reason given was case load and the diversion of judges to Constitution Benches. The previous increase was in 2019, from 31 to 34 in total.

TRAP

38 is the TOTAL including the Chief Justice of India; the Act's own wording says 37 other judges. Also remember a state's name is altered under Article 3 by an ordinary law passed by simple majority — Kerala becoming 'Keralam' is not a constitutional amendment.

Constitutional developments — delimitation, women's reservation and the Census

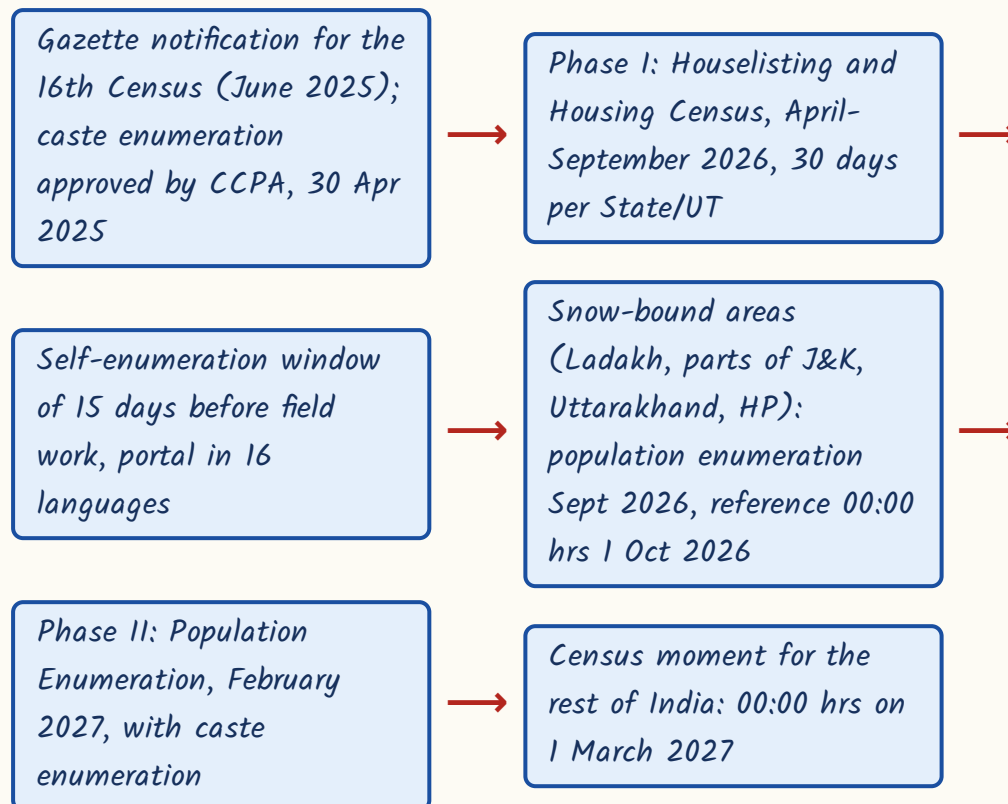
The headline constitutional event of 2026 is a negative one, and negatives are exactly what RPSC likes. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 dealt with delimitation. It proposed raising the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha from 550 to 850, carrying out delimitation on the basis of the Census of 2011, and commencing women's reservation. It was VOTED DOWN on 16 April 2026. So there is no 131st Amendment on the statute book — a constitutional amendment needs a special majority in each House, and this one did not get it. Any statement that it was 'passed in April 2026' is false, and that is precisely the statement RPSC will put in front of you.

- Background: Article 82 requires readjustment after every census; the 84th Amendment, 2001 froze seat numbers until the first census taken after

2026.

- The 106th Amendment, 2023 gave women one-third reservation in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies, but its commencement is tied to a census and the delimitation that follows.
- That is why the Census of 2027 is a polity question, not only a statistics question.

Census 2027 — the two phases



- Census 2027 is India's FIRST fully digital census — mobile app for enumerators and an optional self-enumeration portal.
- Budget about Rs 11,718 crore; roughly 31 lakh enumerators and supervisors.
- Rajasthan's Phase I schedule: self-enumeration 1-15 May 2026, door-to-door enumeration 16 May to 14 June 2026 — self-enumeration was a nationwide feature, not a Rajasthan exclusive.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH cluster 20: constitutional amendments matched to their subject are asked in EVERY single paper. For 2026 the two to hold are the 106th (women's reservation, 2023) and the 131st Bill (delimitation, defeated 2026). Know which is an Act and which is only a Bill.

Supreme Court judgments of consequence

Three rulings from this window are worth full sentences, because each of them changes a right or a definition.

- 17 March 2026 — adoptive mothers are entitled to 12 weeks of PAID maternity leave, irrespective of the age of the adopted child.
- 24 March 2026 — Scheduled Caste status is confined to persons professing Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism; conversion out of these results in loss of SC status. This follows the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950.
- 30 December 2025 — the Court suspended the 100-metre height criterion for classifying the Aravallis and ordered a high-level expert committee covering Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi-NCR.

Notice how each of these attaches to something you already know. The maternity-leave ruling is Article 21 read with service law; the SC-status ruling is the 1950 Presidential Order under Article 341; the Aravalli order is environmental jurisdiction under Article 32 and it directly affects Rajasthan's mining and hill-protection map.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH cluster 23: the judicial expansion of Article 21 and Article 39A were asked in 2018, 2023 and 2024. The March 2026 maternity-leave ruling is the current-affairs face of that same cluster — expect it as either a polity question or a current-affairs one.

CURRENT LINK

As of September 2026 the Aravalli expert committee's definition had not been notified. If it lands before December 2026 it becomes a two-mark item — one national, one Rajasthan. Check in November 2026.

Schemes — new, revamped and extended

Scheme questions are always the same shape: name to sector, or name to outlay. Keep new schemes and extended schemes in two separate lists, because that is how the matching questions are built.

New and revamped schemes, 2026

Scheme	Sector	Outlay and period
BHAVYA Rasayan (Aug 2026)	Three chemical parks	Rs 3,030 crore, 2026-27 to 2030-31
GOBARDhan, revamped (6 Aug 2026)	Compressed biogas	Rs 23,731 crore, 2026-27 to 2035-36
PNG Incentive Scheme (Aug 2026)	Piped natural gas	-

Extensions announced in 2026

Scheme	Extended to	Outlay
PMGSY-III	March 2028	Rs 83,977 crore (revised)

Scheme	Extended to	Outlay
Jal Jeevan Mission	December 2028	About Rs 8.7 lakh crore
UDAN (revamped)	2026-36	Rs 28,840 crore
RoSCTL (textile exports)	September 2026	-

TRAP

Do not swap BHAVYA Rasayan and GOBARDhan. BHAVYA Rasayan = chemical parks (rasayan = chemical, the name tells you). GOBARDhan = compressed biogas from cattle waste (gobar = dung). The 'NOT correctly matched' version of this pair is almost too easy to write.

- The nationwide HPV vaccination campaign was launched by the Prime Minister from AJMER, Rajasthan, on 28 February 2026 — a national scheme with a Rajasthan hook, so it can be asked from either side.
- 6th Positive Indigenisation List (18 August 2026): 405 defence items, business potential about Rs 3,070 crore.
- A Ladakh sitting of the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court was regularised in August 2026.

Rules, frameworks and India's climate pledge

Below the level of statutes sit rules notified by ministries. Four sets from this window are examinable, and each creates a new authority or a new obligation.

- Online Gaming Rules, 2026 (22 April 2026) — set up an Online Gaming Authority, define online money games and require registration of e-sports.
- Telecom User Identification Rules, 2026 (21 August 2026) — mandate Aadhaar-based biometric verification of all telecom subscribers.

- *Petroleum and Natural Gas Rules, 2025* — replaced the 1959 Rules governing oilfield leases.
- *Draft SHANTI Rules, 2026 (August 2026)* — propose single composite licences for nuclear plants, following the Nuclear Energy Act.

On climate, India's updated Nationally Determined Contribution was approved by the Union Cabinet on 25 March 2026. Two numbers: a 47 per cent reduction in the emissions intensity of GDP by 2035, and 60 per cent non-fossil installed electricity capacity by 2035. NDCs are submitted under the Paris Agreement — link this straight to your environment notes.

- *Parliamentary committee themes of 2026 worth naming: cyber crimes and women's safety, oilseeds and pulses, water-efficient seeds, and artificial intelligence — the AI report recommended comprehensive AI legislation.*
- *A Joint Parliamentary Committee was constituted on the Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill.*

Elections 2026, the global indices and the macro numbers

Five assembly elections were decided together, with counting on 4 May 2026. Learn the winner and one number for each state — that is all a one-liner needs.

Assembly election results, counted 4 May 2026

State / UT	Outcome
West Bengal	BJP 206 of 294; Trinamool Congress reduced to 81
Assam	BJP 82 of 126; Himanta Biswa Sarma continued as Chief Minister
Tamil Nadu	Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam single largest with 107 of 234
Kerala	Congress-led UDF
Puducherry	NDA; AINRC 18 of 30; N. Rangaswamy

Now the indices. RPSC has asked India's rank in the World Happiness Report in three consecutive papers. Learn the rank, the denominator and the publisher — the publisher is asked as often as the rank.

India in the global indices (latest editions as of September 2026)

Index	Publisher	India's rank
World Happiness Report 2026	UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network	116 of 147
Global Hunger Index 2025	Concern Worldwide / Welthungerhilfe	102 of 123
Human Development Index	UNDP	130 of 193
Global Innovation Index 2025	WIPO	38 of 139
Corruption Perceptions Index 2025	Transparency International	91 of 180
World Press Freedom Index 2026	Reporters Without Borders	157 of 180
Global Gender Gap Index 2025	World Economic Forum	131 of 148
Henley Passport Index 2026	Henley and Partners	81st
Global Peace Index 2026	Institute for Economics and Peace	127th

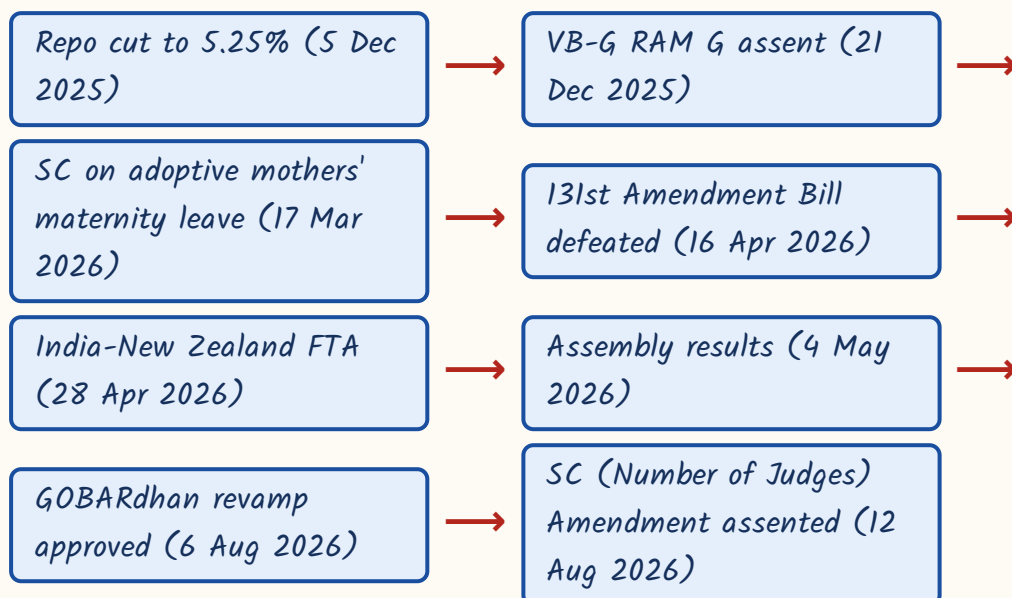
ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH clusters 63 and 86: the World Happiness Report rank was asked in 2021, 2023 AND 2024 — three consecutive papers. Ease of Doing Business, HDI and Hunger also recur. If you learn only one index perfectly, learn Happiness: 116th of 147 in the 2026 edition.

YAAD RAKHO

Pair index with publisher using the initials: Happiness-SDSN (UN), Innovation-WIPO, Corruption-TI, Press Freedom-RSF, Gender Gap-WEF, Passport-Henley. Rank questions change every year; publisher questions never do.

- RBI cut the repo rate to 5.25 per cent on 5 December 2025 (from 5.5 per cent) and held it there through the April and August 2026 reviews.
- GDP growth in Q1 of 2026-27 was 7.8 per cent.
- Trade agreements: India-Oman CEPA (December 2025); India-New Zealand FTA signed 28 April 2026; India-Canada CEPA terms of reference signed 2 March 2026.

Chronology RPSC can ask in order**REVISION RECAP**

1. MGNREGA 2005 repealed; Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 (VB-G RAM G) assented 21 December 2025.
2. VB-G RAM G: 125 days guaranteed, 60:40 Centre-State for general states, 90:10 for NE and Himalayan states, up to 60 days of farm-season pause.
3. Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Act, 2026 — strength 34 to 38 (37 judges besides the CJI); ordinance 17 May, LS 3 Aug, assent 12 Aug 2026.

4. Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 on delimitation — Lok Sabha 550 to 850, Census 2011 basis, women's reservation — DEFEATED 16 April 2026.
5. 84th Amendment 2001 froze seats till the first census after 2026; 106th Amendment 2023 (women's reservation) awaits census and delimitation.
6. Census 2027: first digital census, Phase I houselisting Apr-Sept 2026, Phase II population enumeration Feb 2027, census moment 00:00 hrs 1 March 2027.
7. Snow-bound areas: enumeration September 2026, reference moment 1 October 2026. Caste enumeration in Phase II.
8. Nuclear Energy Act 2025 replaced the Atomic Energy Act 1962 and allows private participation; Insurance FDI raised to 100 per cent.
9. Repealing and Amending Act 2025 repealed 71 laws; Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) 2026 covers 80 central Acts.
10. Tribunals Reforms 2026 creates a National Tribunals Commission; Kerala renamed 'Keralam' under Article 3 by simple majority.
11. CAPF (General Administration) 2026: 50 per cent of IG and 67 per cent of ADG posts by IPS deputation.
12. Winter Session 2025: 1-19 Dec, 15 sittings, 7 Bills passed, 2 referred (Securities Markets Code; Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan).
13. Budget Session 2026: 28 Jan-18 Apr, six Bills passed. Monsoon Session 2026: 20 Jul-13 Aug, 11 of 12 Bills passed.
14. SC 17 Mar 2026 — adoptive mothers get 12 weeks' paid maternity leave; SC 24 Mar 2026 — SC status only for Hinduism, Sikhism, Buddhism.
15. SC 30 Dec 2025 — 100-metre Aravalli criterion suspended, expert committee for Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi-NCR.
16. BHAVYA Rasayan = 3 chemical parks, Rs 3,030 crore; GOBARdhan = compressed biogas, Rs 23,731 crore to 2035-36.
17. Jal Jeevan Mission extended to December 2028 (about Rs 8.7 lakh crore); PMGSY-III to March 2028 (Rs 83,977 crore).
18. Updated NDC (25 Mar 2026): 47 per cent cut in emissions intensity of GDP and 60 per cent non-fossil capacity, both by 2035.
19. Assembly results 4 May 2026: BJP 206/294 in West Bengal, BJP 82/126 in Assam, TVK largest in Tamil Nadu, UDF in Kerala, NDA in Puducherry.
20. Index ranks as of September 2026: Happiness 116/147, Hunger 102/123, HDI 130/193, Innovation 38/139, Corruption 91/180, Press Freedom 157/180.

CA04

National Economy and Union Budget

About 4-6 questions a paper from the economy side of current affairs. Expect one budget figure, one RBI or inflation item, one GST or Finance Commission item, and almost certainly one global index rank. Everything below is current to September 2026 — you must add the October and November releases yourself.

This is the numbers chapter. Union Budget 2026-27, the Economic Survey, the GDP and inflation releases, the RBI's rates, GST 2.0, the 16th Finance Commission and India's rank in the global indices. RPSC does not ask you to analyse the economy. It asks you to recall one figure, one date or one rank correctly. So the work here is memorising a small set of numbers and keeping every number tied to the year it belongs to.

National Economy (to September 2026)

Budget 2026-27

- 1 Feb 2026, Viksit Bharat 2047
- ₹53,47,315 cr total
- Fiscal deficit 4.3%
- Capex ₹12.22 lakh cr

Budget 2025-26

- Fiscal deficit 4.4%
- Nil tax up to ₹12 lakh
- Nuclear Energy Mission
- Urban Challenge Fund

Economic Survey 2025-26

- Tabled 29 Jan 2026
- 2025-26 growth 7.4%
- 2026-27 projected 6.8-7.2%
- FDI USD 81 bn

Data revisions

- GDP base 2011-12 to 2022-23
- CPI base 2012 to 2024=100
- FY26 real growth 7.7%
- Back-series due Dec 2026

RBI (Aug 2026)

- Repo 5.25%
- SDF 5.00%, MSF 5.50%
- Stance neutral
- Governor Sanjay Malhotra

GST 2.0

- 56th Council, Sept 2025
- Slabs 5% and 18%
- 40% demerit rate
- Effective 22 Sept 2025

16th Finance Commission

- Arvind Panagariya
- 2026-27 to 2030-31
- Devolution 41%
- New: GDP contribution 10%

Indices

- Happiness 116th (WHR 2026)
- GII 38th (2025)
- GIFT City 43rd in GFCI
- Fiscal Health Index: Odisha 1st

Trade deals

- UK CETA in force 15 Jul 2026
- Oman CEPA Dec 2025
- NZ FTA Apr 2026
- EU FTA concluded Jan 2026

How to read this chapter — and what RPSC actually does with it

Economy current affairs looks intimidating because it is all numbers. It is not. RPSC picks from a very narrow menu. Look at the past papers — a budget headline figure, a policy rate, a GST slab, a Finance Commission fact, an index rank. That is the whole menu. You do not need to understand fiscal policy. You need to say the right number when a year is named.

- Every figure here is tied to a year. Learn the pair — number AND year — never the number alone.

- The commonest error is mixing Budget 2025-26 figures with Budget 2026-27 figures. RPSC builds whole questions on that.
- Index ranks change with each edition. Learn the rank WITH the edition named.
- Statement-based questions are about 19% of the RAS paper, and this is where they land.
- All content below is current as of September 2026.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the four dates that anchor this whole chapter: 22 September 2025 (new GST rates take effect), 29 January 2026 (Economic Survey), 1 February 2026 (Union Budget AND the 16th Finance Commission report), 15 July 2026 (India-UK CETA enters into force). Nearly every chronological-ordering question in this chapter is built from these four.

Union Budget 2026-27 — the headline numbers

The Union Budget for 2026-27 was presented on 1 February 2026. The theme is Viksit Bharat 2047, built around three 'Kartavyas'. Begin with total expenditure — in any budget, that is the most-asked single number.

Budget 2026-27 — the figures to memorise

Item	Figure
Presented on	1 February 2026
Theme	Viksit Bharat 2047, three 'Kartavyas'
Total expenditure	₹53,47,315 crore, up 7.7% over RE 2025-26
Receipts excluding borrowings	₹36,51,547 crore
Borrowings	₹16,95,768 crore
Nominal GDP growth assumed	10%

Item	Figure
Fiscal deficit	4.3% of GDP
Revenue deficit	1.5% of GDP
Primary deficit	0.7% of GDP
Outstanding liabilities of the Centre	55.6% of GDP
Medium-term debt target	About 50% of GDP by 2030-31

Notice the shift in the fiscal anchor. India no longer targets a fixed fiscal deficit number over the medium term. The anchor is now the DEBT ratio — outstanding liabilities down from 55.6% to about 50% of GDP by March 2031. So if a question asks for the Centre's medium-term fiscal target, the answer is a debt-to-GDP path, not a deficit number. And do not say expenditure fell: total spending is up 7.7% and capital spending up 11.5% over the revised estimates. Only the subsidy bill came down.

- Revenue expenditure: ₹41,25,494 crore.
- Capital expenditure: ₹12,21,821 crore, up 11.5%.
- Interest payments: ₹14,03,972 crore.
- Interest payments equal 26% of total spending and 40% of revenue receipts.
- Subsidies ₹4,54,773 crore, DOWN 3.1% — food ₹2,27,629 crore, fertiliser ₹1,70,799 crore.

Budget 2026-27 — where the money actually goes

Two lists get asked: the biggest ministries and the biggest schemes. Learn each as an ORDER, not as isolated figures. If you know the sequence, a match-the-following solves itself. And note the top scheme — MGNREGA, the name every aspirant grew up with, has been replaced by VB-G RAM G, which now takes the largest scheme allocation in the Budget.

Largest ministry allocations, Budget 2026-27

Rank	Ministry	Allocation
1	Defence	₹7,84,678 crore, about 15% of the Budget
2	Road Transport and Highways	₹3,09,875 crore
3	Railways	₹2,81,377 crore
4	Home Affairs	₹2,55,234 crore
5	Education	₹1,39,289 crore, up 14.2% — the sharpest rise of these five

Largest scheme allocations, Budget 2026-27

Scheme	Allocation
VB-G RAM G (replaced MGNREGA)	₹95,692 crore
Jal Jeevan Mission	₹67,670 crore
PM-KISAN	₹63,500 crore, unchanged
PMAY-Gramin	₹54,917 crore, up 69%
Samagra Shiksha	₹42,100 crore

New initiatives of Budget 2026-27 and their outlays

Initiative	Outlay
Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme	₹40,000 crore (outlay raised to this level)
Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana	₹20,083 crore
Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage (CCUS) mission	₹20,000 crore
Biopharma SHAKTI	₹10,000 crore over five years, for biologics and biosimilars
SME Growth Fund	₹10,000 crore — NOT ₹40,000 crore, that is the electronics scheme
City Economic Regions	₹5,000 crore each

Budget 2026-27 — tax, disinvestment and transfers; and how it differs from 2025-26

Understand the logic first and the details follow. The big personal income-tax giveaway came in the PREVIOUS budget, 2025-26. So in 2026-27 the government left personal slabs alone and pointed relief at companies, financial centres and remittances instead.

- Personal income-tax slabs: UNCHANGED in 2026-27.
- Minimum Alternate Tax cut from 15% to 14%.
- IFSC tax holiday extended from 10 years to 20 years.
- Securities Transaction Tax raised — options to 0.15%, futures to 0.05%.
- TCS on education and medical remittances and on tour packages cut to 2%.
- Disinvestment and other miscellaneous capital receipts: ₹80,000 crore, up 136%.
- Transfers to states ₹26,20,769 crore, of which tax devolution ₹15,26,255 crore.
- Capex loans to states (50-year, interest-free): ₹1,85,000 crore.

TRAP

The nil-tax threshold of ₹12 lakh under the new regime belongs to Budget 2025-26. It was NOT introduced in 2026-27, and it was NOT raised to ₹15 lakh in 2026-27. Both wrong versions are already in circulation as options.

Now hold the two budgets apart. RAS 2026 can legitimately ask about either, so keep a clean two-column picture in your head. Two memory hooks. The deficit goes 4.4 then 4.3 — later year, lower number, which is the direction of the whole fiscal path. And each budget has one ₹20,000 crore mission: 2025-

26 is NUCLEAR, 2026-27 is CARBON capture. N before C matches 2025 before 2026.

Union Budget 2025-26 vs Union Budget 2026-27

Union Budget 2025-26	Union Budget 2026-27
Total expenditure ₹50,65,345 crore	Total expenditure ₹53,47,315 crore
Fiscal deficit 4.4% of GDP	Fiscal deficit 4.3% of GDP
Nil income tax up to ₹12 lakh introduced	Personal slabs unchanged; MAT cut 15% to 14%
Nuclear Energy Mission ₹20,000 crore	CCUS mission ₹20,000 crore
Urban Challenge Fund ₹1 lakh crore	City Economic Regions ₹5,000 crore each
Maritime Development Fund ₹25,000 crore	SME Growth Fund ₹10,000 crore

Economic Survey 2025-26, the growth data and the two base-year revisions

The Economic Survey is tabled one day before the Budget. Two things get asked — the date, and the projection for the coming year. Learn both exactly. Two errors are standard distractors here: it is a current account DEFICIT of 0.8%, not a surplus; and the projection for 2026-27 is 6.8 to 7.2 per cent, not 8.0 to 8.5.

Economic Survey 2025-26 — the asked facts

Item	Figure
Tabled in Parliament	29 January 2026
Growth estimate for 2025-26	7.4%
Projection for 2026-27	6.8% to 7.2%
Medium-term potential growth	About 7%

Item	Figure
Retail inflation, April-December 2025-26	1.7%, against 4.6% a year earlier
Current account deficit, first half of 2025-26	0.8% of GDP, down from 1.3%
FDI in 2025	USD 81 billion
Unemployment rate (2023-24)	3.2%

- Actual outturn beat the Survey: FY 2025-26 real GDP growth 7.7% on Provisional Estimates.
- Q4 of FY 2025-26: 8.6%. Q1 of FY 2026-27: 7.8%.
- Manufacturing grew 10.7% in FY26; agriculture about 3%.
- Retail inflation on the new 2024=100 CPI series: 2.75% in January 2026, 3.21% in February, 3.40% in March, 4.45% in July 2026.
- So the 2026 story is inflation RISING off a very low base, not falling.

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2016, 2018, 2023 AND 2024 — inflation: headline versus core, the tolerance band, cost-push. Some of these were near-verbatim repeats. So do not stop at the latest figure. Be able to say: the RBI's target is 4% CPI inflation with a tolerance band of plus or minus 2 percentage points, that is 2% to 6%; headline CPI includes food and fuel, core CPI excludes them.

Two statistical series were rebased in this window, and base-year questions are a documented RPSC repeat. Keep them apart — the National Accounts and the CPI have DIFFERENT new base years.

The two rebasings — do not merge them

National Accounts (GDP)	Consumer Price Index (CPI)
Old base 2011-12	Old base 2012 = 100
New base 2022-23	New base 2024 = 100
Revised series released February 2026	New series first used for January 2026 data
Back-series to 1950-51 due December 2026	Prices from about 1,400 urban markets and about 1,465 villages
New sources: ASUSE, PLFS, GSTN, e-Vahan, PFMS	Online market prices now included
Double deflation introduced in manufacturing and agriculture	—

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2013, 2021 AND 2024 — national income aggregates and base-year revision (NNP, GNI, which base year is current). With two fresh rebasings in 2026, the chance of a base-year question this time is very high. The safe answers as of September 2026: GDP base 2022-23, CPI base 2024.

CURRENT LINK

Volatile, as of September 2026: the CPI prints for October and November 2026 and the Q2 FY27 GDP release (due end November 2026) all land BEFORE the 6 December 2026 paper. Write the two latest figures onto this page in the last week of November.

RBI monetary policy, banking and the financial sector

The Monetary Policy Committee meets six times a year. What RPSC asks is narrow: the current repo rate, the stance, and the Governor's name. Learn the

full corridor though, because the question often names the SDF or the MSF rather than the repo.

Policy rates as of the August 2026 review

Rate or item	Position
Repo rate	5.25%
Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)	5.00%
Marginal Standing Facility (MSF)	5.50%
Bank Rate	5.50%
Stance	Neutral
Vote	Unanimous
Governor	Sanjay Malhotra

YAAD RAKHO

Corridor trick: SDF is the FLOOR, MSF is the CEILING, repo sits between them — 5.00, 5.25, 5.50, one step of 25 basis points each side. Know the repo and you can derive the other two. And note: in August 2026 the MPC HELD the repo at 5.25%. It did not cut it to 5.25% at that meeting; the rate was already there.

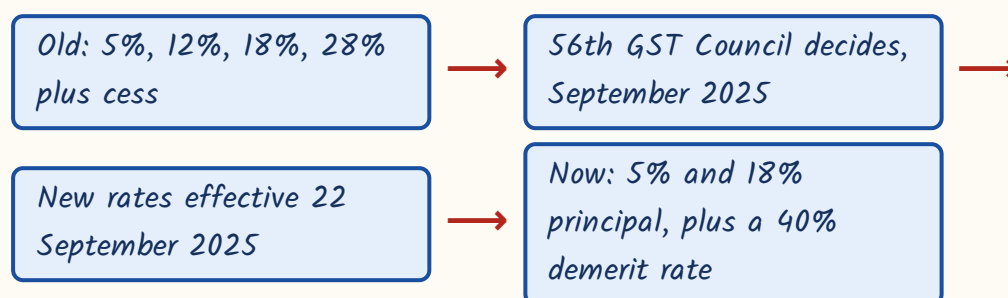
- RBI's August 2026 projections: real GDP growth 6.7% for FY 2026-27, CPI inflation 5.0% for the year, core 4.3%.
- Note the gap — the RBI at 6.7% is more cautious than the Economic Survey at 6.8-7.2% for the same year.
- RBI proposed polymer (plastic) banknotes from the next financial year, subject to field trials.
- RBI Financial Inclusion Index stood at 67 as of March 2025.
- GIFT City ranked 43rd in the Global Financial Centres Index, 38th edition.

- Monsoon Session 2026 ran 20 July to 13 August 2026 and passed four economic laws.
- Bankers' Books Evidence Bill 2026 — replaces the Bankers' Books Evidence Act of 1891.
- MSME Development (Amendment) Bill.
- Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill.
- Tribunals Reforms Bill — creates a National Tribunals Commission.

GST 2.0 and the 16th Finance Commission

These are the two structural reforms of the window, and both are near-certain question sources. Take GST first. The 56th GST Council met in September 2025, chaired as always by the Union Finance Minister, Nirmala Sitharaman. It collapsed the old four-slab structure: the 12% and 28% slabs were abolished. What remains is two principal slabs plus one punitive rate.

GST slab structure, before and after September 2025



What moved where under GST 2.0

Item	New treatment
Individual life and health insurance premiums	Exempt — nil
Cement, air conditioners, televisions	28% down to 18%
Small cars and two-wheelers up to 350 cc	28% down to 18%
Pan masala, gutkha, cigarettes	40% demerit rate
Yachts, helicopters, lottery	40% demerit rate

Item	New treatment
Motorcycles above 350 cc	40% demerit rate

TRAP

Cement is the classic trap — it came DOWN to 18% and is NOT in the 40% slab. And there are TWO principal slabs, not three. Anyone who says '5%, 12% and 18%' has fallen for it.

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2018 AND RAS 2024 — GST and Input Tax Credit. So alongside the new rates, keep the basics ready: GST is a destination-based consumption tax, the Council is chaired by the Union Finance Minister, and input tax credit lets a business set off tax paid on inputs against tax due on output.

The 16th Finance Commission

The 16th Finance Commission's report was tabled in Parliament on 1 February 2026 — the same day as the Budget. Its award period runs 2026-27 to 2030-31 and its chairman is Arvind Panagariya. The most-asked fact will be the devolution share, and the answer is that it was RETAINED at 41%. It was not raised to 45% and it was not cut. Every wrong option plays with that number.

16th FC horizontal devolution criteria and weights

Criterion	Weight
Income distance	42.5%
Population (2011 Census)	17.5%
Demographic performance	10%
Area	10%
Forest and ecology	10%

Criterion	Weight
Contribution to GDP (NEW criterion)	10%

- Four criteria carry 10% each — demography, area, forest-ecology, GDP contribution. Four tens make 40; income distance and population make the other 60.
- Tax-and-fiscal-effort, weighted 2.5% by the 15th FC, has been DROPPED.
- Grants of ₹9.47 lakh crore over five years.
- Of that: rural local bodies ₹4.4 lakh crore, urban local bodies ₹3.6 lakh crore, disaster management ₹1.56 lakh crore.
- Revenue deficit grants to states DISCONTINUED.
- Centre's fiscal deficit recommended to fall to 3.5% of GDP by 2030-31.

India in the global economic indices — the guaranteed question

Listen carefully, because this is the highest-return page in the chapter. Global index rankings are a documented RPSC habit, and one index in particular has been asked in three consecutive papers. Learn the rank WITH the edition year — a rank without an edition is worthless in this exam.

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2021, RAS 2023 AND RAS 2024 — India's rank in the World Happiness Report. Three consecutive papers, which makes it the most reliable single question in the whole economy current-affairs block. As of September 2026 the live edition is the World Happiness Report 2026, released 19 March 2026: Finland first for the NINTH consecutive year, India 116th, up from 118th in the 2025 edition. It is published by the Wellbeing Research Centre at the University of Oxford with Gallup and the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

India's rank — always quote the edition

Index or report	Edition	India's position
World Happiness Report	2026	116th; Finland 1st for the 9th year
Global Innovation Index (WIPO)	2025	38th of 139
Human Development Report (UNDP)	2025	130th
Global Hunger Index	2025	102nd
Corruption Perceptions Index	2025	91st
Global Terrorism Index	2026	13th
Climate Change Performance Index	2026	23rd
Climate Risk Index (Germanwatch)	2026	9th most affected
Global Gender Gap Report (WEF)	2025	131st; Iceland 1st for the 16th year
Global Financial Centres Index	38th edition	GIFT City 43rd
RBI Financial Inclusion Index	March 2025	Value 67
NITI Aayog Fiscal Health Index	Latest edition	Topped by Odisha

Who publishes what — the matching question

Index or report	Publisher
Global Innovation Index	WIPO
Global Terrorism Index and Global Peace Index	Institute for Economics and Peace
Climate Change Performance Index and Climate Risk Index	Germanwatch
Human Development Report	UNDP
World Happiness Report	Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre, with Gallup and UN SDSN
Global Gender Gap Report	World Economic Forum

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2021 AND RAS 2024 — the Ease of Doing Business ranking and DPIIT. Be careful here. The World Bank's Doing Business report was DISCONTINUED; India's last rank on it was 63rd. It has been replaced by the Business Ready (B-READY) assessment, and India's B-READY assessment was scheduled for 2026. If an option offers a shiny new 'Ease of Doing Business rank' for India, be suspicious. Also keep the Climate Change Performance Index (23rd, policy performance) apart from the Climate Risk Index (9th most affected, damage suffered) — both are Germanwatch, and merging them is the standard mistake.

CURRENT LINK

Volatile, as of September 2026: fresh editions of the Global Innovation Index, the Global Hunger Index and the Corruption Perceptions Index are normally released between September and December. Any of them can land before 6 December 2026. Overwrite the rank AND the edition year before the exam.

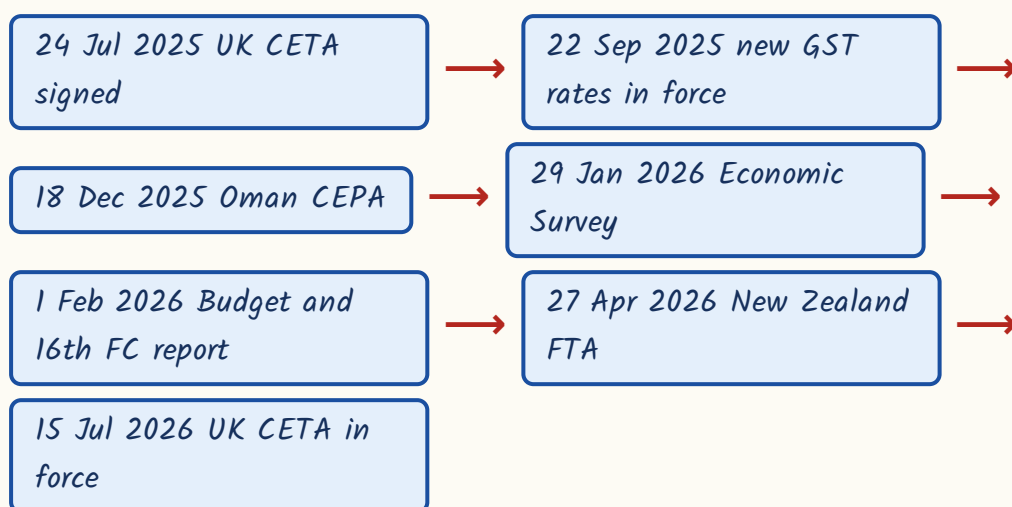
Trade agreements and other economic decisions

India signed or concluded four trade agreements in this window. This is pure partner-and-date recall, and it feeds straight into chronological-ordering questions. Order trick: U-O-E-N — UK, Oman, EU, New Zealand. And remember CETA was SIGNED in July 2025 but came into FORCE in July 2026; those are two separate dates and two separate questions.

India's trade agreements in the window

Agreement	Date	Note
India-UK CETA	Signed 24 July 2025	In force 15 July 2026; 90.2% of India's exports duty-free
India-Oman CEPA	Signed 18 December 2025	Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement
India-EU FTA	Concluded January 2026	About 97% of tariff lines, 99.5% of trade value
India-New Zealand FTA	Signed 27 April 2026	Concluded in the same FTA push

The economic chronology RPSC will scramble



- Under the India-EU FTA, EU tariff elimination covers Indian exports worth about USD 33 billion and 144 EU service subsectors were opened.
- Atal Pension Yojana continued till 2030-31 — Cabinet decision, January 2026.
- BHAVYA-Rasayan chemical parks scheme: ₹3,030 crore.
- GOBARDhan National Circular Bioenergy Scheme: ₹23,731 crore.
- Foreign Assets Disclosure Scheme Rules 2026: undisclosed foreign assets up to ₹1 crore, and property up to ₹5 crore, may be declared by 31 December 2026 on payment of 60% of value.

REVISION RECAP

1. Union Budget 2026-27, presented 1 February 2026, theme Viksit Bharat 2047: total expenditure ₹53,47,315 crore, up 7.7%.
2. Budget 2026-27 deficits: fiscal 4.3%, revenue 1.5%, primary 0.7%; debt 55.6% of GDP heading to about 50% by 2030-31.
3. Capex ₹12.22 lakh crore, up 11.5%; interest payments 26% of spending and 40% of revenue receipts; nominal GDP growth assumed 10%.
4. Ministry order 2026-27: Defence, then Road Transport, Railways, Home, Education.
5. Scheme order 2026-27: VB-G RAM G (which replaced MGNREGA), Jal Jeevan Mission, PM-KISAN, PMAY-Gramin, Samagra Shiksha.
6. New in 2026-27: Electronics Components ₹40,000 cr, VB Rozgar Yojana ₹20,083 cr, CCUS ₹20,000 cr, Biopharma SHAKTI and SME Growth Fund ₹10,000 cr each.
7. Tax 2026-27: slabs unchanged, MAT 15 to 14%, IFSC holiday 10 to 20 years, STT up, TCS cut to 2%; disinvestment target ₹80,000 crore.
8. Budget 2025-26: ₹50,65,345 crore, deficit 4.4%, nil tax to ₹12 lakh, Nuclear Energy Mission ₹20,000 cr, Urban Challenge Fund ₹1 lakh cr.
9. Economic Survey 2025-26, tabled 29 January 2026: 2025-26 growth 7.4%, 2026-27 projected 6.8-7.2%, CAD 0.8% of GDP in H1, FDI USD 81 billion.
10. Actual growth: FY26 7.7% provisional, Q4 FY26 8.6%, Q1 FY27 7.8%, manufacturing 10.7%.
11. GDP base shifted 2011-12 to 2022-23, series out February 2026, back-series to 1950-51 due December 2026; CPI base shifted 2012 to 2024=100.
12. RBI, August 2026: repo 5.25%, SDF 5.00%, MSF and Bank Rate 5.50%, neutral, unanimous; Governor Sanjay Malhotra; FY27 growth 6.7%, CPI 5.0%.
13. 56th GST Council, September 2025: two principal slabs 5% and 18% plus a 40% demerit rate, effective 22 September 2025.
14. GST 2.0: individual life and health insurance exempt; cement, ACs, TVs, small cars and sub-350cc bikes to 18%; pan masala, gutkha, cigarettes, yachts and big bikes at 40%.
15. 16th Finance Commission, Arvind Panagariya, award 2026-27 to 2030-31, report tabled 1 February 2026, devolution retained at 41%.
16. 16th FC weights: income distance 42.5, population 17.5, then 10 each for demographic performance, area, forest-ecology and the NEW GDP contribution; fiscal effort dropped.
17. 16th FC grants ₹9.47 lakh crore; revenue deficit grants discontinued; Centre's fiscal deficit to 3.5% of GDP by 2030-31.
18. Indices: Happiness 116th (WHR 2026, Finland 1st for a 9th year), GII 38th (2025), HDR 130th (2025), Hunger 102nd (2025), Corruption 91st (2025), Gender Gap 131st (2025).

19. Trade: UK CETA signed 24 July 2025 and in force 15 July 2026; Oman CEPA 18 December 2025; EU FTA concluded January 2026; New Zealand FTA 27 April 2026.
20. Monsoon Session 2026 laws: Bankers' Books Evidence Bill replacing the 1891 Act, MSME Amendment, Taxation and Other Laws Amendment, Tribunals Reforms.

CA05

International Affairs and Organisations

About 4-6 questions a paper. Almost always at least one summit-venue item, one index-rank item and one Nobel or global-recognition item. Content is current to September 2026 — the Nobel Prizes 2026, COP31 and the outcome of the BRICS Delhi summit all fall after that and before the exam, so you must add them yourself.

Summits, their host cities and their edition numbers; the agreements India signed and with whom; who took charge in which country; which organisation publishes which report; and the Nobel roll. RPSC turns this material into matching and ordering questions almost mechanically — summit to venue, report to publisher, event to date. So organise it the way the question will come: by organisation, by region, by calendar.

International Affairs (to September 2026)

Climate

- COP30 Belem, Nov 2025
- Global Mutirao package
- COP31 Antalya, Australia presides
- No fossil-fuel roadmap

Asia-Pacific

- 22nd ASEAN-India, Kuala Lumpur
- APEC 2025 Gyeongju
- India is not an APEC member

Hosted by India

- AI Impact Summit, Feb 2026
- 11th Raisina Dialogue, Mar 2026
- 18th BRICS Summit, Sep 2026

G20

- 20th: Johannesburg 2025
- First on African soil
- Ubuntu, 122 paragraphs
- 21st: Miami, Dec 2026, US chair

West Asia

- US 20-point Gaza plan, 29 Sep 2025
- Sharm el-Sheikh summit 13 Oct 2025
- UNSC Res 2803, 17 Nov 2025
- Board of Peace and ISF

Nobel 2025

- Peace: Maria Corina Machado
- Literature: Krasznahorkai
- Chemistry: MOFs
- Economics: creative destruction

BRICS and SCO

- 17th BRICS Rio, Jul 2025
- India chairs BRICS 2026
- 18th Summit New Delhi
- 25th SCO Tianjin; Kyrgyzstan next

India's bilaterals

- Putin visit, 23rd Summit
- 16th India-EU Summit, Delhi
- UAE: USD 200 bn by 2032
- Uzbekistan CSP, Aug 2026

India in indices

- Happiness 116th (2026)
- HDR 130th (2025)
- Hunger 102nd (2025)
- Terrorism 13th (2026)

How to read this chapter

International affairs feels endless because the news is endless. It is not endless in the exam. RPSC asks four kinds of question here and only four. Where was the summit held. Which edition number was it. Who publishes that report and where does India rank. And put these four events in order. Prepare for those four shapes and the section is covered.

- Learn every summit as a triple — EDITION NUMBER, HOST CITY, YEAR. Any one of the three can be the question.

- Learn every report as a pair — REPORT and PUBLISHING ORGANISATION. That is a match-the-following waiting to happen.
- Learn every bilateral as PARTNER, WHAT WAS SIGNED, THE TARGET NUMBER. The target number is what gets asked.
- Match-the-following is about 12% of the RAS paper, and current affairs is where RPSC concentrates it.
- Everything below is current as of September 2026.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the 2025 summit sequence — it is the backbone of every ordering question in this chapter. SCO Tianjin (31 Aug-1 Sep), Gaza summit Sharm el-Sheikh (13 Oct), ASEAN-India Kuala Lumpur (26 Oct), APEC Gyeongju (31 Oct-1 Nov), COP30 Belem (10-22 Nov), G20 Johannesburg (Nov), Putin in Delhi (4-5 Dec). Country order: China, Egypt, Malaysia, Korea, Brazil, South Africa, India.

The climate track — COP30 at Belem and COP31 at Antalya

COP30 of the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change was held at Belem, in the Brazilian Amazon, from 10 to 22 November 2025. The venue matters — Brazil deliberately put the climate conference inside the Amazon. About 56,000 delegates registered. The President of the conference was Andre Correa do Lago.

COP30 — the facts that get asked

Item	Detail
Where and when	Belem, Brazil, 10-22 November 2025
President	Andre Correa do Lago
Registered delegates	About 56,000
Outcome package	'Global Mutirao' — Portuguese for collective effort

Item	Detail
Adaptation finance	Call to TRIPLE it by 2035
New mechanism	Just Transition Mechanism
Voluntary initiative	Global Implementation Accelerator
Fossil fuels	NO phase-out roadmap in the text

That last line is the whole political story of COP30, and it is the most examinable thing about it. The final decision text contained no roadmap for phasing out fossil fuels. The presidency instead promised separate roadmaps on fossil fuels and on deforestation at COP31. Now COP31 itself has an odd arrangement, agreed as a compromise announced on 20 November 2025: Türkiye HOSTS it, at Antalya, while AUSTRALIA holds the presidency and leads the negotiations. Host country and presiding country are different — exactly the kind of detail RPSC builds a question on.

- If an option says COP30 adopted a binding fossil-fuel phase-out roadmap, it is wrong.
- The Global Implementation Accelerator belongs to COP30 — NOT to the G20 Johannesburg Summit. That swap is already an exam option.
- WMO Greenhouse Gas Bulletin 2025: atmospheric CO₂ reached 423.9 ppm in 2024.

CURRENT LINK

Volatile, as of September 2026: COP31 at Antalya takes place in November 2026, before the 6 December paper. Its outcome document, and whether the promised fossil-fuel roadmap actually appeared, will be fresh current affairs. Add it in the last fortnight.

The G20 — Johannesburg 2025 and Miami 2026

The 20th G20 Leaders' Summit was held at Johannesburg, South Africa, in November 2025. Its defining fact is simple and highly examinable: it was the **FIRST** G20 Leaders' Summit ever held on African soil. The theme was 'Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability'. The Leaders' Declaration ran to 122 paragraphs and invoked Ubuntu, the African philosophy of shared humanity.

G20 Johannesburg 2025 — what was launched

Initiative	What it does
Mission 300	Electricity for 300 million people in sub-Saharan Africa by 2030, World Bank with AfDB
Nelson Mandela Bay Target	On youth NEET rates — young people not in education, employment or training
Cost of Capital Commission	On the cost of borrowing for developing economies
Critical Minerals Framework	On critical mineral supply chains

- India's proposals at Johannesburg — G20 Initiative on Countering the Drug-Terror Nexus.
- G20 Global Healthcare Response Team.
- Global Traditional Knowledge Repository.
- Open Satellite Data Partnership.
- Critical Minerals Circularity Initiative.

Now the handover. The United States holds the G20 presidency for 2026. The 21st G20 Summit is scheduled for 14-15 December 2026 at Trump National Doral in Miami, Florida. That is **AFTER** your exam date of 6 December, so for

RAS 2026 the summit itself is not yet news — but the presidency and the venue are.

TRAP

Do not merge the two G20s. Johannesburg = 20th, November 2025, South Africa, theme 'Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability', Ubuntu. Miami = 21st, December 2026, United States. And the Global Implementation Accelerator belongs to COP30, not to either G20.

BRICS, SCO, ASEAN and APEC — the plurilateral calendar

Take these four together, because RPSC sets them against each other inside a single matching question. The trick is the edition numbers. Learn them as one block.

Summit, edition, host — learn all three columns

Summit	Edition	Host city and date
G20 Leaders' Summit	20th	Johannesburg, November 2025
SCO Summit	25th	Tianjin, China, 31 August-1 September 2025
BRICS Summit	17th	Rio de Janeiro, July 2025
ASEAN-India Summit	22nd	Kuala Lumpur, 26 October 2025
APEC Economic Leaders' Meeting	2025	Gyeongju, Republic of Korea, 31 October-1 November 2025
India-Russia Annual Summit	23rd	New Delhi, 4-5 December 2025
UNFCCC Conference of Parties	COP30	Belem, Brazil, 10-22 November 2025

- *PM Modi attended the 25th SCO Summit at Tianjin in person; Kyrgyzstan takes the SCO chair after China's 2025 term.*

- PM Modi joined the 22nd ASEAN-India Summit virtually.
- The 22nd ASEAN-India Summit was at KUALA LUMPUR, not Jakarta. Jakarta only houses the ASEAN Secretariat — the secretariat's city is not the summit's city.
- India is a member of the G20, SCO and BRICS. India is NOT a member of APEC.
- BRICS works strictly by CONSENSUS. Further expansion needs unanimous agreement, not a two-thirds majority.

India's BRICS chairship, 2026

- India assumed the BRICS chairship on 1 January 2026 and hosts the 18th BRICS Summit.
- 18th BRICS Summit: New Delhi, at Bharat Mandapam, 12-13 September 2026.
- Motto: 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability' — the initials spell BRICS.
- Logo and website launched 13 January 2026; foreign ministers met in Delhi 14-15 May 2026.
- Members participating: Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, South Africa and the UAE.
- Guest chairs invited: African Union (Burundi), ASEAN (Philippines), CELAC (Uruguay), Gulf Cooperation Council (Bahrain).

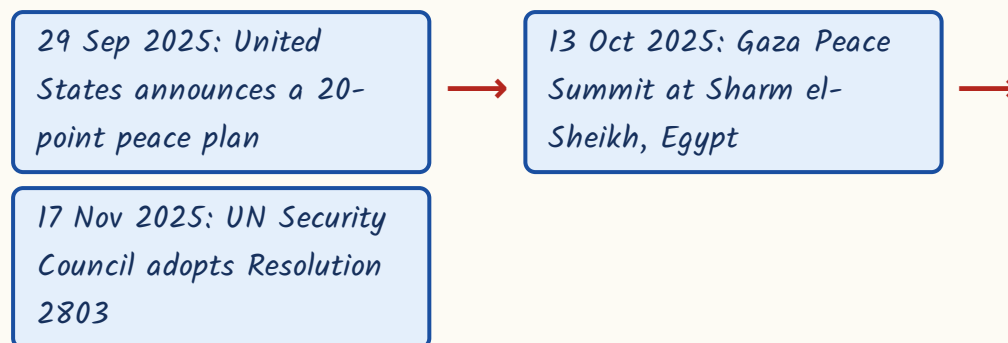
CURRENT LINK

Volatile, as of early September 2026: the 18th BRICS Summit had not yet been held when these notes were compiled. Its declaration, the name of that declaration and who chairs BRICS in 2027 will all be new facts. Fill them in — a summit India hosted is an almost certain question.

West Asia — Gaza, the peace plan and Resolution 2803

This is the one conflict in the window that produced hard, datable facts, which is exactly why it is examinable. Follow it as three steps: a plan, then a summit, then a Security Council resolution.

The Gaza peace process — three dates



UNSC Resolution 2803 — the detail RPSC will test

Item	Detail
Adopted on	17 November 2025
Vote	13-0, with China and Russia ABSTAINING
Endorsed	The 20-point United States peace plan
Authorised	A 'Board of Peace' and an International Stabilization Force for Gaza

TRAP

Resolution 2803 was NOT adopted unanimously. The vote was 13 in favour, none against, two abstentions — China and Russia. 'Fifteen in favour, none against, no abstentions' is the wrong option, and it is the one most candidates tick.

- The Gaza Peace Summit was at Sharm el-Sheikh in EGYPT, a repeat venue for West Asian diplomacy.

- The Board of Peace and the International Stabilization Force both come from Resolution 2803, not from the Sharm el-Sheikh summit.

India's bilateral year — the visits and what was signed

Do not try to remember the diplomacy. Remember three things per partner — the occasion, the headline agreement, and the target number. It is the target numbers that RPSC actually asks about.

India's major bilateral engagements, December 2025 to August 2026

Partner	Occasion and date	Headline outcome
Russia	23rd India-Russia Annual Summit; Putin in India, 4-5 December 2025	16 inter-governmental agreements and 15 MoUs; trade target USD 100 billion by 2030
European Union	16th India-EU Summit, New Delhi, January 2026	India-EU FTA concluded — about 97% of tariff lines, 99.5% of trade value
Germany	Visit of 12-13 January 2026	12 Joint Declarations of Intent, 5 MoUs, 2 other agreements; visa-free transit through Germany for Indian passport holders
UAE	State visit to India, 19 January 2026	Trade target DOUBLED to USD 200 billion by 2032; 10-year HPCL-ADNOC LNG deal from 2028; UAE investment in Dholera SIR
Uzbekistan	August 2026	Ties raised to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership; trade target USD 5 billion by 2030

- India-Russia trade at the time of the December 2025 summit was about USD 68.7 billion, heavily skewed towards Russian exports.
- Agreements on temporary labour activity and on combating irregular migration were among those signed with Russia.
- Under the India-EU deal, EU tariff elimination covers Indian exports worth about USD 33 billion and 144 EU service subsectors were opened to India.

- SIPRI data: Russia has supplied about 40% of India's arms imports.

TRAP

Two target numbers, two partners, and they are easy to swap. RUSSIA is USD 100 billion by 2030. UAE is USD 200 billion by 2032. Uzbekistan is the small one, USD 5 billion by 2030. And the 16th India-EU Summit was held in NEW DELHI, not Brussels.

- PM Modi's five-nation tour ran 15-20 May 2026.
- Countries in order: UAE, the Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, Italy.
- It included the 3rd India-Nordic Summit, hosted by Norway.
- It was the Prime Minister's first visit to Norway in over four decades.

Summits India hosted at home

A state PSC pays extra attention to what happened on Indian soil, so this short list is worth more than its length suggests. Four events, each with one distinctive hook.

Hosted by India, 2026

Event	Where and when	The hook
India AI Impact Summit	New Delhi, 16-20 February 2026	Theme 'People, Planet, Progress'; Guinness World Record with 250,946 AI-responsibility pledges
11th Raisina Dialogue	New Delhi, 5-7 March 2026	India's flagship geopolitics conference
9th Indian Ocean Conference	Port Louis, MAURITIUS, 10-12 April 2026	An Indian initiative, but held abroad — note the venue
18th BRICS Summit	New Delhi, Bharat Mandapam, 12-13 September 2026	India's BRICS chairship year

TRAP

The 9th Indian Ocean Conference was at Port Louis, MAURITIUS — not in India. It is an Indian-origin conference held abroad, which is exactly why it makes a good wrong-venue option. Do not place it in Delhi.

- The AI Impact Summit's Guinness figure, 250,946 pledges, is the sort of oddly specific number RPSC likes.
- The 16th India-EU Summit of January 2026 was also held in New Delhi — add it to this list when you revise venues.
- Note the theme wording: 'People, Planet, Progress'. Themes get asked verbatim.

Changes of leadership abroad, and the Nobel Prizes 2025

Leadership changes come as a straight one-liner: who became the first woman Prime Minister of which country. Keep the list short and be certain about the 'firsts'. Of these four, Takaichi is the near-certain question, because 'first woman' plus a named country makes a perfect one-liner.

Leadership changes in the window

Country	Leader	When
Japan	Sanae Takaichi — JAPAN'S FIRST WOMAN PRIME MINISTER	Elected 21 October 2025
Bolivia	Rodrigo Paz, President	Took office November 2025
Netherlands	Rob Jetten, Prime Minister of a new minority government	Sworn in February 2026
Chile	Jose Antonio Kast, President	Took office March 2026

Now the Nobel Prizes for 2025. Six prizes, six answers. Learn the category-to-laureate pairing, because the question always comes as a match or as a 'which pair is NOT correctly matched'. The commonest confusion is Medicine with Chemistry — regulatory T cells is MEDICINE, metal-organic frameworks is CHEMISTRY. Peace and Literature are the two most-asked categories in any state PSC paper, so Machado and Krasznahorkai must be automatic. The prize is worth about 11 million Swedish kronor.

Nobel Prizes 2025

Category	Laureate or laureates	For
Physiology or Medicine	Mary E. Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi	Peripheral immune tolerance; regulatory T cells
Physics	John Clarke, Michel Devoret, John Martinis	Macroscopic quantum tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit
Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar Yaghi	Metal-organic frameworks (MOFs)
Literature	Laszlo Krasznahorkai, Hungary	—
Peace	Maria Corina Machado, Venezuela	—
Economic Sciences	Joel Mokyr, Philippe Aghion, Peter Howitt	Innovation-driven growth; creative destruction

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2021 AND RAS 2023 — the TIME influential and pioneers lists. RPSC reliably carries one 'global recognition' question in its current-affairs block. In a paper held in December 2026 the Nobel roll is the most likely form of that question, so treat the six 2025 laureates as compulsory, not optional.

CURRENT LINK

Volatile, as of September 2026: the 2026 Nobel Prizes are announced from 5 to 12 October 2026, with the Peace Prize on 9 October at Oslo. That is two months before your exam, which puts the 2026 laureates squarely inside the syllabus. Write all six names onto this page the moment they are announced.

International organisations, their reports and India's ranks

Here is the highest-frequency item in the whole current-affairs paper. Global index rankings are a documented RPSC habit — Happiness, Ease of Doing Business, HDI, Hunger. Two rules, and only two. Always attach the EDITION year to the rank. Always know who PUBLISHES the report.

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2021, RAS 2023 AND RAS 2024 — India's rank in the World Happiness Report. Three consecutive papers, which makes it the most repeated current-affairs fact in the exam. As of September 2026 the live edition is the World Happiness Report 2026, released 19 March 2026: Finland first for the ninth consecutive year, India 116th, up from 118th in the 2025 edition. It is published by Oxford's Wellbeing Research Centre with Gallup and the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

India's ranks — always quote the edition

Index or report	Edition	India
World Happiness Report	2026	116th; Finland 1st for the 9th year running
Global Innovation Index	2025	38th of 139
Global Terrorism Index	2026	13th
Climate Change Performance Index	2026	23rd; topped by Denmark

Index or report	Edition	India
Climate Risk Index	2026	9th most affected
Human Development Report	2025	130th
Global Hunger Index	2025	102nd
Corruption Perceptions Index	2025	91st
Global Gender Gap Report	2025	131st; Iceland 1st for the 16th year running

The two Germanwatch indices — do not merge them

Climate Change Performance Index 2026	Climate Risk Index 2026
Measures climate POLICY and performance	Measures climate IMPACTS suffered
India 23rd	India 9th most affected
Topped by Denmark	A ranking of vulnerability, not of merit
A better rank is good news	A higher position means more damage

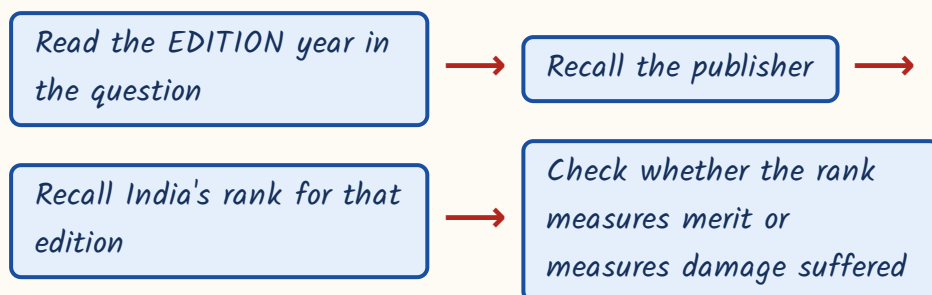
Report to publisher — the matching question

Report or index	Published by
Global Innovation Index	WIPO
Global Terrorism Index and Global Peace Index	Institute for Economics and Peace
Climate Change Performance Index and Climate Risk Index	Germanwatch
Human Development Report	UNDP
World Happiness Report	Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre, with Gallup and UN SDSN
Global Gender Gap Report	World Economic Forum
Greenhouse Gas Bulletin	World Meteorological Organization
Global TB Report	World Health Organization
Arms transfer data	SIPRI, the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute

ASKED IN RAS

ASKED IN RAS 2021 AND RAS 2024 — the Ease of Doing Business ranking and DPIIT. One change of state to note: the World Bank's Doing Business report was DISCONTINUED, and India's last rank on it was 63rd. It has been replaced by the Business Ready (B-READY) assessment, and India's B-READY assessment was scheduled for 2026. Treat any fresh 'Ease of Doing Business rank' for India with suspicion.

- WMO Greenhouse Gas Bulletin 2025: atmospheric CO₂ at 423.9 ppm in 2024.
- WHO Global TB Report 2025: TB cases fell 21% between 2015 and 2024.
- SIPRI: Russia accounts for about 40% of India's arms imports.

How to attack any index question in the hall**REVISION RECAP**

1. COP30: Belem, Brazil, 10-22 November 2025; President Andre Correa do Lago; about 56,000 delegates.
2. COP30 outcome, the 'Global Mutirao' package: triple adaptation finance by 2035, a Just Transition Mechanism, and NO fossil-fuel phase-out roadmap.
3. COP31, 2026: hosted at Antalya, Turkiye, with AUSTRALIA holding the presidency — the compromise was announced 20 November 2025.
4. 20th G20: Johannesburg, November 2025, the first ever on African soil; theme 'Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability'; 122-paragraph declaration invoking Ubuntu.
5. G20 Johannesburg launches: Mission 300, Nelson Mandela Bay Target, Cost of Capital Commission, Critical Minerals Framework. The US holds the 2026 presidency; the 21st Summit is at Miami, 14-15 December 2026.

6. India's G20 proposals: Drug-Terror Nexus initiative, Global Healthcare Response Team, Traditional Knowledge Repository, Open Satellite Data Partnership, Critical Minerals Circularity.
7. 25th SCO Summit: Tianjin, 31 August-1 September 2025, Modi present; Kyrgyzstan chairs next.
8. 17th BRICS: Rio de Janeiro, July 2025. India chairs BRICS in 2026 and hosts the 18th Summit at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, 12-13 September 2026, motto 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'. BRICS decides by consensus.
9. 22nd ASEAN-India Summit: Kuala Lumpur, 26 October 2025, Modi virtual. APEC 2025: Gyeongju, Korea — and India is not an APEC member.
10. Gaza: US 20-point plan 29 September 2025, Sharm el-Sheikh summit 13 October 2025, UNSC Resolution 2803 on 17 November 2025 adopted 13-0 with China and Russia abstaining.
11. Resolution 2803 authorised a Board of Peace and an International Stabilization Force for Gaza.
12. 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit: Putin in India 4-5 December 2025; 16 agreements and 15 MoUs; trade target USD 100 billion by 2030 from about USD 68.7 billion.
13. 16th India-EU Summit at NEW DELHI, January 2026; FTA concluded covering 97% of tariff lines and 99.5% of trade value, USD 33 billion of Indian exports, 144 EU service subsectors.
14. UAE state visit 19 January 2026: trade target doubled to USD 200 billion by 2032, HPCL-ADNOC LNG deal from 2028, Dholera investment. Germany, 12-13 January 2026: visa-free transit for Indian passport holders.
15. Uzbekistan raised to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in August 2026, with a USD 5 billion trade target by 2030.
16. Modi's five-nation tour, 15-20 May 2026: UAE, Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, Italy — including the 3rd India-Nordic Summit and his first Norway visit in over forty years.
17. Hosted by India: AI Impact Summit, New Delhi, 16-20 February 2026, theme 'People, Planet, Progress', Guinness record 250,946 pledges; 11th Raisina Dialogue 5-7 March 2026. The 9th Indian Ocean Conference was at Port Louis, Mauritius.
18. Leadership abroad: Sanae Takaichi, Japan's first woman PM, 21 October 2025; Rodrigo Paz in Bolivia; Rob Jetten in the Netherlands; Jose Antonio Kast in Chile.
19. Nobel 2025 — Medicine: Brunkow, Ramsdell, Sakaguchi. Physics: Clarke, Devoret, Martinis. Chemistry: Kitagawa, Robson, Yaghi for MOFs. Literature: Krasznahorkai. Peace: Maria Corina Machado. Economics: Mokyr, Aghion, Howitt.
20. India in indices: Happiness 116th (2026), GII 38th (2025), Terrorism 13th (2026), CCPI 23rd (2026), Climate Risk 9th (2026), HDR 130th (2025), Hunger 102nd (2025), Corruption 91st (2025), Gender Gap 131st (2025).

CA06

Science, Technology, Environment and Defence in the News

Expect 4-6 questions a paper from this chapter — typically one ISRO item, one DRDO or defence item, one environment or wildlife number, and one health or global-science item. Every fact below is as of September 2026. October and November 2026 developments you must add yourself.

Science and technology is the biggest single bucket in the RAS paper — 18 to 23 questions every year — and a good slice of it is current affairs rather than textbook science. This chapter is that slice: what ISRO launched, what DRDO tested, which exercise was held where, what COP30 agreed and how many Ramsar sites India now has. The facts are recent, datable, and RPSC asks them straight.

Science, Tech, Environment & Defence (to Sept 2026)

ISRO

- CMS-03 on LVM3-M5, 2 Nov 2025
- BlueBird Block-2, LVM3-M6, 24 Dec 2025
- PSLV-C62 FAILED, 12 Jan 2026
- EOS-05 on GSLV-F17, 4 Sept 2026
- Gaganyaan G1 + Vyommitra

Missiles / DRDO

- Agni-5 MIRV, 8 May 2026
- BMD AD-2 interceptor, June 2026
- Rudram-II and Rudram-III
- Project Kusha, NASM-MR

Platforms & numbers

- INS Dunagiri, Sanshodhak, Agray
- AMCA RFP, May 2026
- C-295 at Vadodara, 10 June 2026
- Exports Rs 38,424 crore

Exercises

- MILAN, Visakhapatnam
- Vayushakti-26, Pokhran
- Ajeya Warrior, Bold Kurukshetra in Rajasthan
- Malabar, Yudh Abhyas

AI / chips / quantum

- India AI Impact Summit, Feb 2026
- New Delhi Declaration
- Semicon 2.0, 15 July 2026
- NQM 1,000 km QKD

Health

- Ebola PHEIC, May 2026
- HPV drive, 14-year-old girls
- Trachoma-free, April 2025
- 25% of world TB burden

Climate

- COP30 Belem, Nov 2025
- 'Global Mutirao' package
- Triple adaptation finance by 2035
- Just Transition Mechanism

Wetlands & wildlife

- 101 Ramsar sites, Aug 2026
- Glaw Lake is the 101st
- Rajasthan has 5 Ramsar sites
- Tigers 3,682, lions 891

Global science

- Nobel Physics: quantum circuit
- Nobel Chemistry: MOFs
- Nobel Medicine: immune tolerance
- Sarnath = 45th UNESCO site

How to read this chapter — and what RPSC actually does with it

Do not try to understand the science here. RPSC does not test understanding in this bucket. It tests recall of a name, a place, a date or a number. Which rocket carried which satellite. Where the exercise was held. How many Ramsar sites. Who chaired COP30. So read this chapter the way you read a list of kings and their capitals — pair by pair.

- Every item here is dated. Learn the fact WITH its date; RPSC builds chronology questions out of exactly this.
- Launch vehicle to satellite, exercise to country, missile to range — these pairings are the match-the-following fodder.
- Anything with a running count — Ramsar sites, tiger reserves, cheetahs — can change before December. Learn the number and the as-of date together.
- Rajasthan links inside a science question score double: Pokhran, Keoladeo, Sambhar, Khichan, Menar, Siliserh. Mark them.
- Everything below is current as of September 2026.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho five anchor dates for the whole chapter: 2 November 2025 (CMS-03), 10-22 November 2025 (COP30 at Belem), 12 January 2026 (PSLV-C62 fails), 16-21 February 2026 (India AI Impact Summit), 4 September 2026 (EOS-05). Nearly every ordering question in this chapter is built from dates in that band.

ISRO — the launch record from November 2025 to September 2026

ISRO's window here has one very heavy launch, one big commercial launch, one failure and one first. Learn all four as a set. The Chairman, as of September 2026, is V. Narayanan, who is also Secretary, Department of Space. Note that name — RPSC likes asking who heads an organisation.

The four missions to memorise (Nov 2025 – Sept 2026)

Mission	Date	Payload and outcome
LVM3-MS	2 November 2025	CMS-03, about 4,400 kg, into Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit

Mission	Date	Payload and outcome
LVM3-M6	24 December 2025	BlueBird Block-2 for AST SpaceMobile, into Low Earth Orbit
PSLV-C62	12 January 2026	EOS-NI + 14 co-passengers — FAILED, anomaly in third stage (PS3)
GSLV-F17	4 September 2026	EOS-05 into sub-GTO — 19th flight of the GSLV

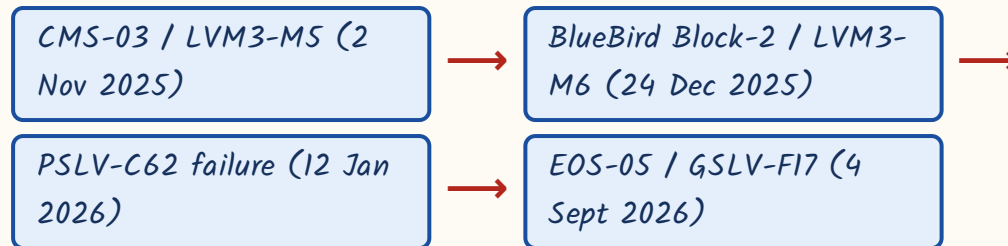
TRAP

The 'heaviest satellite' trap — read this twice. CMS-03 (2 November 2025, LVM3-M5) was the heaviest COMMUNICATION satellite launched to GTO from Indian soil, about 4,400 kg. Then on 24 December 2025 LVM3-M6 lifted BlueBird Block-2, which ISRO Chairman V. Narayanan called the heaviest satellite ever lifted from Indian soil by an Indian launcher. So never write 'CMS-03 is the heaviest satellite launched from India' without the words 'at the time'. If the option says heaviest communication satellite to GTO — CMS-03. If it says heaviest satellite from Indian soil — as of September 2026, BlueBird Block-2.

- BlueBird Block-2 belongs to AST SpaceMobile (USA), a direct-to-mobile satellite constellation.
- It was a commercial mission of NewSpace India Limited (NSIL), ISRO's commercial arm — remember NSIL for the 'which arm of ISRO' question.
- PSLV-C62 was ISRO's first mission of 2026 and its second PSLV failure within a year, after PSLV-C61.
- EOS-05 is India's FIRST imaging satellite in geosynchronous orbit — that superlative is the examinable bit.
- A geosynchronous imaging satellite stares at the same large area again and again: agriculture, disaster response, land monitoring.
- Gaganyaan sequence: uncrewed first. G1 flies on LVM3 carrying the humanoid robot Vyommitra; the first crewed flight (H1) is targeted for 2027.

- Vehicle logic in one line — PSLV for polar and small commercial loads, GSLV for geosynchronous, LVM3 for the heavy lifts and Gaganyaan.

ISRO chronology in this window — learn the order



ASKED IN RAS

ISRO launch-vehicle-to-satellite matching was asked in RAS Pre 2013, 2016, 2018 and 2023 — one of the most reliable science repeats. The old record they lean on is PSLV-C37 (February 2017), 104 satellites in a single flight. Know the old record AND the four new missions above.

DRDO — missiles, interceptors and the systems that get asked

DRDO has appeared in every RAS paper since 2016. The pattern is simple: a system name and what it does, or a test and where it was conducted. Two sites do most of the work — Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island (Wheeler Island) off Odisha for the big missiles, and Chandipur for shorter-range trials.

Systems in the news, 2025-26

System	What it is	Key fact
Agni-5 (MIRV)	Long-range ballistic missile	Advanced flight test 8 May 2026, Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha
AD-2	Ballistic missile defence interceptor	Tests 10-11 June 2026; described as reaching 'intercontinental class'
Rudram-II	Anti-radiation missile	Range about 300 km
Rudram-III	Anti-radiation missile	Range about 550-600 km

System	What it is	Key fact
Project Kusha	Long-range surface-to-air defence	350+ km; induction target 2028-29
NASM-MR	Naval anti-ship missile, medium range	About 350 km; maiden trial completed

- *MIRV = Multiple Independently Targetable Re-entry Vehicle. One missile, several warheads, each on a different target. India first demonstrated it under Mission Divyastra.*
- *Ballistic Missile Defence: three flight tests on 10-11 June 2026 validated the multi-layered system.*
- *An anti-radiation missile homes in on enemy radar emissions — that is what Rudram does.*
- *Range ladder to memorise: Rudram-II about 300 km, NASM-MR about 350 km, Kusha 350+ km, Rudram-III about 550-600 km.*
- *Do not mix the families: AD-1 and AD-2 are BMD interceptors, Astra is air-to-air, Akash is surface-to-air, Agni is ballistic.*

ASKED IN RAS

DRDO in every RAS Pre since 2016 — Lukoskin (the vitiligo drug), the beyond-visual-range missile Astra, MANPADS, and the DRDO motto 'Balasya Mulam Vigyanam' (strength has its source in science). Learn those old staples alongside the new tests; RPSC mixes both in one question.

Platforms, production numbers and who sits in the chair

Pure recall here — three ships, two aircraft programmes, three numbers, one appointment. Take them in that order and do not let the ship names blur.

- 21 June 2026, three commissionings on one day: INS Dunagiri (Project 17A stealth frigate), INS Sanshodhak (Survey Vessel Large), INS Agray (Arnala-class anti-submarine warfare craft).
- All three had over 75% indigenous content — that percentage is the examinable detail.
- AMCA, the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft, is India's FIFTH-generation fighter. RFP issued 27 May 2026 to three shortlisted development partners; first flight targeted 2032, deliveries from 2035.
- The first India-assembled C-295 transport aircraft flew on 10 June 2026 from the Tata-Airbus facility at VADODARA — India's first private-sector military aircraft assembly line.
- Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth was appointed Chief of the Army Staff on 13 June 2026.
- Trick for the ships: D-S-A on 21 June. Dunagiri fights, Sanshodhak surveys (sanshodhan = survey/research), Agray hunts submarines.

The defence numbers for FY 2025-26

Item	Figure
Defence production	About Rs 1.78 lakh crore — a record
Defence exports	About Rs 38,424 crore, roughly \$4.1 billion — a 63% jump
DFPDS-2026	Unveiled 4 June 2026; delegates procurement powers of Rs 1.25+ lakh crore a year

TRAP

AMCA is FIFTH-generation, not fourth. RPSC's 'which pair is NOT correctly matched' questions live on this one. And the C-295 line is at Vadodara — not Hyderabad, not Nashik, not Kanpur.

Military exercises — the highest-yield matching topic in defence

Exercises are asked as pure matching — name to partner country, or name to place. There is no logic to reason out, only pairs to learn. Do 2026 first, then 2025, and mark the ones held in Rajasthan, because those are the ones RPSC will reach for.

Exercises 2026

Exercise	Partner or type	Where
MILAN 2026	Multilateral naval	Visakhapatnam; theme 'Camaraderie, Cooperation, Collaboration'
Vayushakti-26	IAF integrated firepower demonstration	Pokhran Range, Jaisalmer, RAJASTHAN
Khanjar-XIII	India-Kyrgyzstan special forces	Assam
Dharma Guardian	India-Japan	Uttarakhand
Vajra Prahar	India-USA special forces	Himachal Pradesh
Dosti-17	India-Sri Lanka-Maldives coast guards	Male
Lamitiye	India-Seychelles	Seychelles

Exercises 2025

Exercise	Partner	Where
Malabar-2025	Quad — India, USA, Japan, Australia	Near Guam
Ajeya Warrior-25	India-United Kingdom	RAJASTHAN
Bold Kurukshetra	India-Singapore	RAJASTHAN
Yudh Abhyas 2025	India-United States	Alaska, USA — NOT on Indian soil
Trishul	Tri-service, Indian	Along the Pakistan border
Konkan / JAIMEX / SLINEX / Garuda	UK / Japan / Sri Lanka / France	Naval and air bilaterals
TROPEX	Indian Navy's largest exercise	Indian Ocean Region

YAAD RAKHO

Country hooks that never fail: Khanjar = Kyrgyzstan (both K), Lamitiye = Seychelles, Dharma Guardian = Japan, Vajra Prahar and Yudh Abhyas = USA, Garuda = France, SLINEX = Sri Lanka, Dosti = Sri Lanka + Maldives coast guard. Two location catches: Yudh Abhyas 2025 was in Alaska, and Khanjar-XIII was in Assam — Himachal was Vajra Prahar.

AI, semiconductors, quantum — and the 2025 science Nobels

India hosted the year's big AI event. The India AI Impact Summit ran 16-21 February 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, with over 100 countries and 20 international organisations. It closed with the NEW DELHI DECLARATION, endorsed by 92 countries and organisations. Venue, dates, declaration name — that is the question.

- Summit outputs: Global AI Impact Commons; Equitable AI Transition Playbook (with the ILO); Charter for Democratic Diffusion of AI; Trusted AI Commons.
- Also launched: Alliance for Advancing Inclusion Through AI (with UNICEF) and a Network of AI for Science Institutions.
- Investment pledges around the summit crossed \$200 billion.
- Reliance pledged \$110 billion over seven years; Google announced a \$15 billion AI hub at VISAKHAPATNAM; Lightspeed \$10 billion; General Catalyst \$5 billion.
- IndiaAI Mission GPU capacity: rising from over 38,000 to over 58,000 GPUs.

Semiconductors — India Semiconductor Mission 2.0

- The Union Cabinet approved the Semicon 2.0 framework on 15 July 2026 with an outlay of about Rs 1,27,500 crore; the first phase was Rs 76,000

crore.

- Twelve manufacturing units approved, cumulative investment over Rs 1.64 lakh crore — one silicon fab, one silicon carbide fab, one gallium nitride micro-LED display fab and nine packaging units.
- Commercial production has begun in three units — Micron (Sanand, Gujarat), CG Semi and Kaynes.
- Micron's Sanand plant is India's first semiconductor assembly and test facility.
- The first full silicon fab is scheduled for commissioning around 2028 (as of September 2026).

Quantum — the National Quantum Mission

- Approved by the Union Cabinet in April 2023 under the Department of Science and Technology, with an outlay of about Rs 6,000 crore up to 2030-31.
- Targets: intermediate-scale quantum computers of 50 to 1,000 physical qubits within eight years, and a quantum communications network of about 2,000 km.
- April 2026 — the Mission announced a 1,000 km secure quantum communication (quantum key distribution) milestone, among the longest QKD deployments anywhere.
- It runs through four thematic hubs: quantum computing, quantum communication, quantum sensing and metrology, quantum materials and devices.
- Link this to the 2025 Physics Nobel below — that prize was for quantum behaviour in a hand-held superconducting circuit, the foundation of quantum computing.

Nobel Prizes 2025 — the three science prizes

Prize	Laureates	For
Physics	John Clarke, Michel Devoret, John Martinis	Macroscopic quantum tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit
Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar Yaghi	Metal-organic frameworks (MOFs)
Medicine	Mary Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi	Peripheral immune tolerance — regulatory T cells

Health, disease and vaccines

Health current affairs comes in two shapes — an outbreak or emergency declaration, and an elimination or certification milestone. Keep the two lists apart in your head and you will not mix them up in the exam hall.

- May 2026 — the WHO declared EBOLA a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC) for outbreaks in the DRC and Uganda; a Sudan-strain vaccine trial began in Uganda.
- April 2025 — India was certified TRACHOMA-free by the WHO. Trachoma is a bacterial eye infection and a leading infectious cause of blindness.
- India carries about 25% — one-fourth — of the global TB burden (Global TB Report 2025).
- March 2026 — nationwide HPV vaccination campaign launched for 14-YEAR-OLD girls, against cervical cancer.
- January 2026 — India's first 'AI clinic' opened at GIMS, Greater Noida.

Vaccines and therapies in the news — learn the developer

Name	Against	Developer
R21/Matrix-M	Malaria	University of Oxford; manufactured by Serum Institute of India
DengiAll	Dengue	ICMR with Panacea Biotec

Name	Against	Developer
HILLCHOL	Cholera, oral	Bharat Biotech
BIRSA 101	Sickle-cell disease, gene therapy	CSIR-IGIB

- December 2025 — Niger became the FIRST African country validated for eliminating onchocerciasis (river blindness).
- 2025 — Nepal was declared malaria-free.
- October 2025 — Maldives achieved triple elimination of mother-to-child transmission of HIV, Hepatitis B and syphilis.

TRAP

R21/Matrix-M is Oxford's malaria vaccine, made in India by the Serum Institute — it is NOT a Bharat Biotech or Bharat Immunologicals product. The 'which pair is NOT correctly matched' question in this area is usually built on R21.

Environment — COP30, wetlands, wildlife and heritage

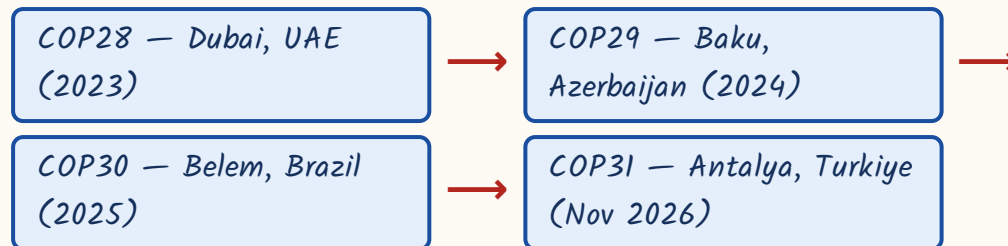
Start with COP30. Held at BELEM in Brazil, in the Amazon, from 10 to 22 November 2025. President: Brazilian diplomat Andre Correa do Lago. The final decision package was named the 'GLOBAL MUTIRAO' — mutirao is a Brazilian-Portuguese word for collective community effort. Venue, president, package name. Those three are the question.

- COP30 called for TRIPLING adaptation finance by 2035.
- It created a new JUST TRANSITION MECHANISM.
- It launched a voluntary 'Global Implementation Accelerator'.
- It did NOT put a fossil-fuel phase-out roadmap in the decision text — the presidency promised separate voluntary roadmaps instead. That negative is

the favourite statement-question trap.

- Simon Stiell is the Executive Secretary of the UNFCCC — do not confuse the Executive Secretary with the COP President.

The COP sequence you must be able to place



COP29 vs COP30 — do not mix these up

COP29 — Baku, Nov 2024	COP30 — Belem, Nov 2025
Remembered as the finance COP	Remembered for the 'Global Mutirao' package
New collective quantified goal on climate finance	Call to triple ADAPTATION finance by 2035
President Mukhtar Babayev	President Andre Correa do Lago
No just-transition body	New Just Transition Mechanism created

Now wetlands. A Ramsar site is a wetland of international importance under the Ramsar Convention of 1971. India crossed the century in 2026. As of August 2026 India has 101 Ramsar sites across 28 States and Union Territories, and the 101st is GLAW LAKE in Arunachal Pradesh, designated on 3 August 2026.

- Other 2026 additions: Chhari-Dhand (Gujarat, in Kutch), and Shekha Jheel, Patna Bird Sanctuary and Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary — all in Uttar Pradesh.
- Largest Indian Ramsar site: Sundarban Wetland, West Bengal, about 4,230 sq km.
- Smallest: Renuka (Himachal Pradesh) and Vembannur (Tamil Nadu), 0.2 sq km each.

- *Montreux Record* is the list of Ramsar sites whose ecological character is under threat. India has TWO — Keoladeo Ghana National Park, Rajasthan (1990) and Loktak Lake, Manipur (1993).

Rajasthan's five Ramsar sites — learn all five with years

Site	District or area	Designated
Keoladeo Ghana National Park	Bharatpur	1981
Sambhar Lake	Jaipur-Nagaur-Ajmer	1990
Khichan	Phalodi — demoiselle crane wintering site	2025
Menar	Udaipur	2025
Siliserh	Alwar	2025

ASKED IN RAS

Keoladeo and Sambhar as Rajasthan's Ramsar sites were asked in RAS Pre 2016 and 2023. With Khichan, Menar and Siliserh added in 2025, the same question comes back with the count 'five'. If an option offers Chhari-Dhand as a Rajasthan site, reject it — that one is in Kutch, Gujarat.

Latest reported wildlife populations — four figures to memorise

Species	Number	Source and cycle
Tiger	3,682	All-India Tiger Estimation 2022
Leopard	13,874	2022, fifth cycle, NTCA-WII
Snow leopard	718	SPA1, 2019-23
Asiatic lion	891	2025 estimate, up from 674 in 2020

- India had 58 tiger reserves as of March 2025.
- Project Cheetah: 53 cheetahs in India as of March 2026, including 33 India-born cubs, at Kuno National Park and Gandhi Sagar Sanctuary, both in Madhya Pradesh.

- **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** — formally established 12 March 2024, HEADQUARTERED IN INDIA, with Rs 150 crore of Indian support for 2023-28.
 - IBCA covers SEVEN big cats: tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, jaguar and puma.
 - The 2022 All-India Tiger Estimation was itself a Guinness record exercise — the world's largest camera-trap wildlife survey.
-
- The Ancient Buddhist Site of SARNATH, Uttar Pradesh, was inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List in July 2026, at the 48th session of the World Heritage Committee held at Busan, South Korea.
 - Sarnath is India's 45TH World Heritage Site, inscribed under criteria (iii) and (vi) — the place of the Buddha's first sermon and the founding of the Sangha.
 - India ranks 6th in the world and 2nd in the Asia-Pacific region by number of World Heritage Sites (as of September 2026).
 - Keep the earlier Indian link ready: the 46th session of the World Heritage Committee was hosted by India at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, in July 2024.

CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the Ramsar count (101) and the cheetah count (53) are both live numbers and can move before 6 December 2026. Check the Ramsar Convention website and PIB releases of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in the last week of November, then update these two figures in your revision sheet.

What in this chapter will have moved by December — and where to check

These notes were compiled in September 2026. Your exam is on 6 December 2026. That is about ten weeks in which several numbers above will change. Do not re-read the whole chapter in December — refresh only the items in this list.

- ISRO launches after 4 September 2026 — anything after EOS-05 is not in these notes. Check the mission list on isro.gov.in.
- The Ramsar count, 101 in August 2026 — every new designation moves it. Check ramsar.org and PIB.
- Cheetah numbers, tiger reserve count and any fresh tiger reserve notification — NTCA and MoEFCC releases.
- COP31, scheduled for November 2026 at Antalya, Turkiye, as settled at Belem. Its outcome lands weeks before your paper; note the decision's name and one headline outcome.
- Nobel Prizes 2026 — announced in the first half of October 2026. Learn 2025 and 2026 side by side.
- New DRDO tests, ship commissionings and any change of service chiefs after September 2026 — PIB Defence.
- Semiconductor units entering production, and any new IndiaAI or National Quantum Mission announcement.

CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the 2026 Nobel Prizes had not been announced when these notes were written. Announcements run through the first half of October 2026. Add the 2026 laureates before you sit the paper — Physics, Chemistry and Medicine belong in this chapter, Peace and Literature in the awards chapter.

REVISION RECAP

1. CMS-03 on LVM3-M5, 2 Nov 2025, about 4,400 kg — heaviest communication satellite to GTO from Indian soil.
2. BlueBird Block-2 on LVM3-M6, 24 Dec 2025 — heaviest satellite lifted from Indian soil; AST SpaceMobile, a commercial NSIL mission.
3. PSLV-C62 failed on 12 Jan 2026, third stage PS3; payload EOS-NI with 14 co-passengers.
4. EOS-05 on GSLV-F17, 4 Sept 2026 — India's first imaging satellite in geosynchronous orbit; ISRO Chairman V. Narayanan.
5. Gaganyaan: uncrewed G1 on LVM3 carries Vyommitra; crewed flight targeted 2027.
6. Agni-5 MIRV test 8 May 2026, Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island; MIRV = Multiple Independently Targetable Re-entry Vehicle.
7. AD-2 interceptor reached 'intercontinental class' in the 10-11 June 2026 BMD tests; NASM-MR about 350 km, maiden trial done.
8. Rudram-II about 300 km, Rudram-III about 550-600 km, Project Kusha 350+ km with induction targeted 2028-29.
9. AMCA is fifth-generation — RFP 27 May 2026, first flight 2032, deliveries 2035; C-295 assembly line at Vadodara.
10. 21 June 2026 — INS Dunagiri, INS Sanshodhak and INS Agray commissioned, each over 75% indigenous.
11. Defence production about Rs 1.78 lakh crore, exports about Rs 38,424 crore (up 63%); Army Chief Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth from 13 June 2026.
12. Vayushakti-26 at Pokhran; Ajeya Warrior-25 (UK) and Bold Kurukshetra (Singapore) in Rajasthan; Yudh Abhyas 2025 in Alaska.
13. India AI Impact Summit 16-21 Feb 2026 at Bharat Mandapam — New Delhi Declaration, 92 endorsements, over \$200 billion pledged.
14. Semicon 2.0 approved 15 July 2026, about Rs 1,27,500 crore; production running at Micron Sanand, CG Semi and Kaynes.

15. National Quantum Mission approved April 2023; 1,000 km quantum key distribution milestone announced April 2026.
16. COP30 at Belem, 10-22 Nov 2025, President Andre Correa do Lago, package 'Global Mutirao' — triple adaptation finance by 2035, no fossil-fuel roadmap.
17. 101 Ramsar sites as of August 2026, the 101st being Glaw Lake, Arunachal Pradesh; Rajasthan has five; Montreux Record has Keoladeo and Loktak.
18. Tigers 3,682, leopards 13,874, snow leopards 718, Asiatic lions 891; 58 tiger reserves; 53 cheetahs in March 2026.
19. IBCA established 12 March 2024, headquartered in India, covering seven big cats, Rs 150 crore for 2023-28.
20. Sarnath became India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site at the 48th session, Busan, July 2026; Nobel science 2025 — quantum circuits, MOFs, immune tolerance.

CA07

Sports, Awards, Books, Persons and Places in the News

About 5-7 questions a paper. The sports block is guaranteed. Awards are near-guaranteed. TIME lists are a documented repeat, asked in RAS Pre 2021 and 2023. Everything below is as of September 2026 — and note that the Asian Games open on 19 September 2026, so those results are NOT in these notes.

Every RAS paper carries a sports block of four to six questions, and it always contains at least one Rajasthani athlete. Add the awards — Khel Ratna, Padma, gallantry, Nobel, Booker, Pulitzer, Oscar, Jnanpith — plus books and their authors, persons in the news and places in the news, and you have the most predictable scoring block in the whole current-affairs section. This chapter is pure pairing: name to event, name to prize, book to author, place to happening.

Sports, Awards, Books, Persons, Places (to Sept 2026)

CWG Glasgow 2026

- 23 Jul - 2 Aug 2026
- India 4th, 39 medals
- 13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze
- India topped boxing

Rajasthan angle

- Arundhati Choudhary, KOTA
- Boxing gold, women's 70 kg
- Beat Chantelle Reid, England
- Guaranteed exam target

Cricket

- Men's T20 WC 2026 in India
- Final Ahmedabad, 8 Mar 2026
- India beat NZ by 96 runs
- Women's ODI WC 2025 — first title

Sports awards 2025

- Khel Ratna NOT conferred
- 17 Arjuna awardees
- Committee: Justice A.K. Mishra
- RKPP: Army Paralympic Node

Civilian & gallantry

- Padma 2026 — 131 awards
- 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, 113 Shri
- 3 Kirti Chakras
- 13 Shaurya Chakras

Nobel 2025

- Peace: Maria Corina Machado
- Literature: Laszlo Krasznahorkai
- Physics, Chemistry, Medicine
- Economics: Mokyr, Aghion, Howitt

Books & letters

- Booker 2025: Flesh, Szalay
- 60th Jnanpith: R. Vairamuthu
- Sahitya Akademi: Crimson Spring
- Pulitzer Fiction: Angel Down

Persons & obituaries

- V. Narayanan, Dhiraj Seth
- Ram Sutar (d. 18 Dec 2025)
- Swaraj Kaushal, Baba Adhav
- TIME 100: Ranbir Kapoor

Places

- Belem, Glasgow, Ahmedabad
- Bharat Mandapam
- Samarkand, Paphos
- Aichi-Nagoya

How to read this chapter — and what RPSC actually does with it

This is the easiest chapter in current affairs to score in, and the easiest to lose marks in through sloppiness. Nothing here needs thinking. Everything here needs exact pairing — who won what, where, in which event, in which year. The

commonest mistake in the exam hall is knowing the person but not the event, or the prize but not the year.

- RAS carries a sports block of 4-6 questions in every paper, and it always includes at least one Rajasthani athlete.
- In this window the Rajasthan name is Arundhati Choudhary of Kota. Learn her event and her weight class, not just her name.
- For every award learn three things: who, for what work, and in which year's cycle.
- For every tournament learn host city, host country, date and the runner-up — RPSC asks the beaten finalist as often as the winner.
- Everything below is as of September 2026.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho four anchor dates for this chapter: 10 October 2025 (Nobel Peace announced), 8 March 2026 (T20 World Cup final at Ahmedabad), 15 April 2026 (TIME 100 list released), 23 July 2026 (Commonwealth Games open at Glasgow). Every chronological-ordering question in this chapter can be solved from those four.

Commonwealth Games 2026, Glasgow — the biggest block in this chapter

The 2026 Commonwealth Games were held at GLASGOW, Scotland, from 23 July to 2 August 2026. Glasgow had also hosted in 2014, so if an option offers Birmingham or Victoria, reject it. India finished FOURTH on the medal table with 39 medals — 13 gold, 17 silver and 9 bronze. Learn that split; the total alone is not enough for a statement question.

The story of these Games for India was boxing. India TOPPED the boxing medal table with 7 golds and 3 silvers. Seven names give you seven possible questions, and one of them is your Rajasthan answer.

India's boxing medals at Glasgow 2026

Boxer	Category	Medal
Sakshi	Women's 51 kg	Gold
Preeti	Women's 54 kg	Gold
Jaismine	Women's 57 kg	Gold
Priya	Women's 60 kg	Gold
ARUNDHATI CHOUDHARY (Kota, Rajasthan)	Women's 70 kg	Gold — beat Chantelle Reid of England
Sachin	Men's 60 kg	Gold
Ankush	Men's 80 kg	Gold
Lovlina Borgohain	Women's 75 kg	Silver
Jadumani Singh Mandengbam	Men's 55 kg	Silver
Narender	Men's 90+ kg	Silver

- Other Indian golds: Mirabai Chanu (weightlifting, women's 48 kg), Asmita Dey (judo, women's 48 kg), Harsh Singh (judo, men's 60 kg).
- Para athletics golds: Sharmila Dhankar (shot put F57), Dilip Gavitt (100 m T47), Soman Rana.
- Notable silvers: Neeraj Chopra (javelin), Tejaswin Shankar (decathlon), Sarvesh Kushare (high jump), Murali Sreeshankar, Praveen Chithravel (triple jump).

- Gulveer Singh, the long-distance runner, was India's **ONLY** double medallist at Glasgow 2026.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS keeps a standing sports block and it has always found room for a Rajasthani sportsperson. For the 2026 paper that slot points straight at Arundhati Choudhary of KOTA — Commonwealth Games boxing gold, women's 70 kg. Learn her district, her sport, her weight class and the opponent she beat. If a question asks 'which district', the answer is Kota.

TRAP

Two catches from Glasgow. First, Lovlina Borgohain won **SILVER**, not gold — she is the famous name, so she is the natural wrong option in a 'who did NOT win gold' question. Second, Neeraj Chopra took silver in the javelin at these Games. Big name does not mean gold. Read the medal colour in the option.

Cricket — the two World Cups India won

Two world titles fall in this window, one men's and one women's, and RPSC will ask at least one of them. Keep the two apart: different year, different format, different opponent in the final.

India's two World Cup wins in this window

ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026	ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025
Hosted by INDIA, 7 Feb - 8 Mar 2026	Played in November 2025
Final at AHMEDABAD on 8 March 2026	India's FIRST ODI World Cup title
India beat NEW ZEALAND by 96 runs	India beat SOUTH AFRICA in the final
India's record THIRD T20 World Cup	A maiden world title for the women's team

- Three superlatives attach to the men's 2026 win — record third T20 World Cup, first team to win back-to-back T20 World Cups, first team to win the trophy at home.
- The margin, 96 runs, is itself examinable. So is the venue, Ahmedabad.
- The Women's T20 World Cup 2026 was played in England and Wales, 12 June to 5 July 2026 — do not confuse it with the women's ODI title of November 2025.

The rest of the 2026 sports calendar

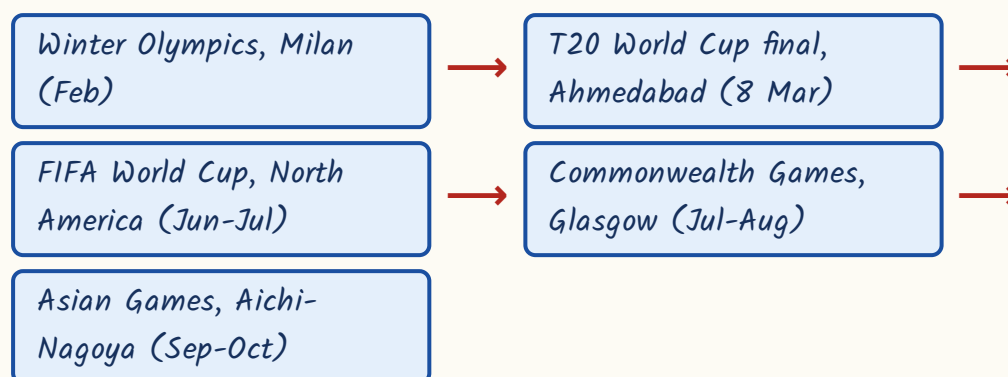
2026 is a crowded sporting year. RPSC does not ask you for results from all of them — it asks host city and host country. So learn the calendar as a list of venues in date order, and you have covered most of what can be asked.

Major events of 2026 — learn host and dates

Event	Host	Dates
Winter Olympic Games	Milan (Milano-Cortina), Italy	6-22 February 2026
Winter Paralympic Games	Milan, Italy	6-15 March 2026
FIFA World Cup	USA, Mexico and Canada	11 June - 19 July 2026
ICC Women's T20 World Cup	England and Wales	12 June - 5 July 2026
Commonwealth Games	Glasgow, Scotland	23 July - 2 August 2026
FIH Hockey World Cups	Belgium and Netherlands	15-30 August 2026
Asian Games (20th)	Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	19 September - 4 October 2026
Youth Olympic Games	Dakar, Senegal	31 October - 13 November 2026

- Chess 2026: the FIDE Candidates and Women's Candidates were at PAPHOS, Cyprus (28 March - 16 April); the Chess Olympiad is at SAMARKAND, Uzbekistan (15-28 September); the World Chess Championship is due in December 2026.
- Badminton: the BWF World Championships 2026 were hosted by INDIA at NEW DELHI, 17-23 August 2026.
- Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty exited in the quarter-finals there; the pair had won bronze at the BWF World Tour Finals 2025.
- The 2026 FIFA World Cup was the first with 48 teams.
- Do not pair the Asian Games with Hangzhou — Hangzhou hosted the 2022 edition, which was actually held in 2023. The 2026 host is Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.

The 2026 sporting year in order — solve ordering questions from this



CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the 20th ASIAN GAMES open at Aichi-Nagoya on 19 September 2026 and run to 4 October, followed by the Asian Para Games. Every result from those Games falls AFTER these notes were compiled. India's Asian Games medal tally, its gold medallists and any Rajasthani medallist are prime RAS material — you must add them in November. Also still ahead: the Youth Olympics at Dakar and the World Chess Championship in December 2026.

National Sports Awards 2025 — announced August 2026

The National Sports Awards for 2025 were announced in August 2026. The selection committee was headed by retired Supreme Court judge Justice Arun Kumar Mishra. The headline is a negative one, and negatives are exactly what RPSC likes: the MAJOR DHYAN CHAND KHEL RATNA WAS NOT CONFERRED — the committee found no suitable recipient.

- Khel Ratna is India's highest sporting honour; it was renamed from Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna to Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna in 2021.
- Arjuna Award 2025 — 17 recipients.
- Arjuna Award (Lifetime Achievement) 2025 — I. Arumainayagam, football.
- Dronacharya 2025 (regular) — Parveer Singh (athletics), Chhote Lal Yadav (boxing), Neha Nandkumar Chavan (shooting).
- Dronacharya (Lifetime) 2025 — Dharmendra Singh Yadav (boxing), Virender Kumar (wrestling).
- Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar 2025 — Army Paralympic Node, Pune. This award goes to institutions, not individuals.

Arjuna Award 2025 — the names most likely to be asked

Sport	Recipients
Athletics	Tejaswin Shankar, Priyanka Goswami, Muhammed Ajmal
Badminton	Treesa Jolly, Pullela Gayatri Gopichand
Chess	Vidit Gujarathi, Divya Deshmukh
Hockey	Lalremsiami, Rajkumar Pal
Boxing	Narender
Shooting	Dhanush Srikanth, Akhil Sheoran
Rowing	Arvind Singh

ASKED IN RAS

Sports awards are a standing RAS category. The framing to expect in 2026 is a statement question: 'The Khel Ratna was not conferred in the 2025 cycle' — that statement is CORRECT. RPSC loves an award that was withheld, because most candidates assume every award is given every year.

YAAD RAKHO

Keep the four sports awards separate by who receives them: Khel Ratna to the single outstanding sportsperson, Arjuna to consistent performers, Dronacharya to COACHES, Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar to institutions and organisations. If the option names an organisation, the answer is the Protsahan Puraskar.

Civilian and gallantry awards

Two lists, both announced around Republic Day. Padma Awards are civilian; the gallantry awards are military and police. Learn the counts for 2026 and the hierarchy for both, because the hierarchy question is asked more often than the names.

- Padma Awards 2026 — 131 awards in all: 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, 113 Padma Shri.
- Order of the civilian honours: Bharat Ratna is the highest, then Padma Vibhushan, then Padma Bhushan, then Padma Shri.
- Republic Day 2026 gallantry list — President Droupadi Murmu approved 70 gallantry awards (6 posthumous) and 301 other decorations.
- Three KIRTI CHAKRAS: Group Captain Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair, Major Arshdeep Singh, Naib Subedar Doleshwar Subba.

- Thirteen SHAURYA CHAKRAS were announced in the same list.

Peacetime gallantry awards, highest first



TRAP

Do not mix the two gallantry ladders. In WAR the order is Param Vir Chakra, then Maha Vir Chakra, then Vir Chakra. In PEACETIME it is Ashoka Chakra, then Kirti Chakra, then Shaurya Chakra. Param Vir Chakra and Ashoka Chakra are equivalent in rank, one for wartime and one for peacetime. RPSC's negative-framed question is usually built on swapping Kirti and Shaurya.

Nobel, Booker, Pulitzer, Oscar, Jnanpith — and the books behind them

Awards questions are matching questions. Build the table in your head as prize-to-person-to-work, and you can answer whichever of the three the paper gives you. Start with the Nobels for 2025 — all six.

Nobel Prizes 2025 — all six

Category	Laureate(s)	Note
Peace	Maria Corina Machado	Venezuelan opposition leader
Literature	Laszlo Krasznahorkai	Hungarian novelist
Physics	John Clarke, Michel Devoret, John Martinis	Quantum tunnelling in an electric circuit
Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar Yaghi	Metal-organic frameworks

Category	Laureate(s)	Note
Medicine	Mary Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi	Peripheral immune tolerance
Economic Sciences	Joel Mokyr, Philippe Aghion, Peter Howitt	Innovation-driven growth, creative destruction

- **Booker Prize 2025** — David Szalay for the novel 'Flesh', announced 11 November 2025. Szalay is a Hungarian-born British writer.
- **60th Jnanpith Award** — R. Vairamuthu, the Tamil poet and lyricist, announced in 2026; he is the third Tamil writer to receive it (as of September 2026).
- **59th Jnanpith Award** — Vinod Kumar Shukla (Hindi), announced in 2025; the first writer from Chhattisgarh to win it.
- **Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025** — English: Navtej Sarna for 'Crimson Spring', a novel set around the Jallianwala Bagh massacre. Hindi: Mamta Kalia for 'Jeete Jee Allahabad', a memoir.
- **Pulitzer Prizes 2026** — Fiction: Daniel Kraus for 'Angel Down'. Drama: Bess Wohl for 'Liberation'.

Book to author — the pairing RPSC actually asks

Book	Author	Prize
Flesh	David Szalay	Booker Prize 2025
Crimson Spring	Navtej Sarna	Sahitya Akademi 2025, English
Jeete Jee Allahabad	Mamta Kalia	Sahitya Akademi 2025, Hindi
Angel Down	Daniel Kraus	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction 2026
Liberation	Bess Wohl	Pulitzer Prize for Drama 2026

- **98th Academy Awards, 2026** — Best Picture: 'One Battle After Another'. Best Director: Paul Thomas Anderson. Best Actor: Michael B. Jordan for 'Sinners'. Best Actress: Jessie Buckley for 'Hamnet'.

- 79th BAFTA Film Awards 2026 — Best Film: 'One Battle After Another'. Leading Actress: Jessie Buckley for 'Hamnet'.
- 68th Grammy Awards 2026 — Album of the Year: Bad Bunny. Record of the Year: Kendrick Lamar with SZA, 'Luther'. Best New Artist: Olivia Dean.
- Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2023 — Mohanlal, presented in 2025.

Other international honours to know

Award	Recipient	Field
Abel Prize 2026	Gerd Faltings	Mathematics
Pritzker Architecture Prize 2026	Smiljan Radic (Chile)	Architecture
Templeton Prize 2026	Simon Conway Morris	Science and religion
Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development 2025	Graca Machel (Mozambique)	Peace and development

ASKED IN RAS

The Sahitya Akademi award in the RAJASTHANI language was asked in RAS Pre 2018 and 2023 — Rajasthani is one of the 24 languages the Akademi recognises, and RPSC treats it as a state-specific question. These notes carry the English and Hindi winners for 2025; before December, look up the RAJASTHANI winner for 2025 on sahitya-akademi.gov.in and write it in the margin here. Do not go into the exam without that name.

TRAP

Nobel Literature is a classic trap because candidates remember the previous year. Han Kang of South Korea won in 2024; the 2025 prize went to LASZLO KRASZNAHORKAI of Hungary. Same trap with the Oscars — Michael B. Jordan won Best Actor for 'Sinners' at the 98th Academy Awards; any other name in the option is a distractor.

CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the Booker Prize 2026 winner had not been announced when these notes were written — the Booker is normally announced in November. The Nobel Prizes for 2026 are announced in early October 2026. Both land before your exam. Add them here.

Persons, obituaries, places — and the TIME lists

Three small lists that together produce a question or two every year. Persons in the news means 'who holds this post now'. Obituaries mean 'who was this person'. Places in the news means 'what happened here'. Each one is a single-line pairing.

- V. Narayanan — Chairman, ISRO, and Secretary, Department of Space.
- Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth — Chief of the Army Staff from 13 June 2026.
- Andre Correa do Lago — President of COP30 at Belem.
- Justice Arun Kumar Mishra — headed the National Sports Awards 2025 selection committee.
- Droupadi Murmu — President of India, who approved the Republic Day 2026 gallantry awards.

Obituaries in the window — learn the identification, not the date alone

Name	Who they were	Died
Ram Sutar	Sculptor who designed the Statue of Unity; died aged 100	18 December 2025
Swaraj Kaushal	Senior advocate; former Governor of Mizoram	5 December 2025
Baba Adhav	Social activist; died aged 95	9 December 2025
Kalyan Chatterjee	Bengali actor	9 December 2025

Places in the news — place to event

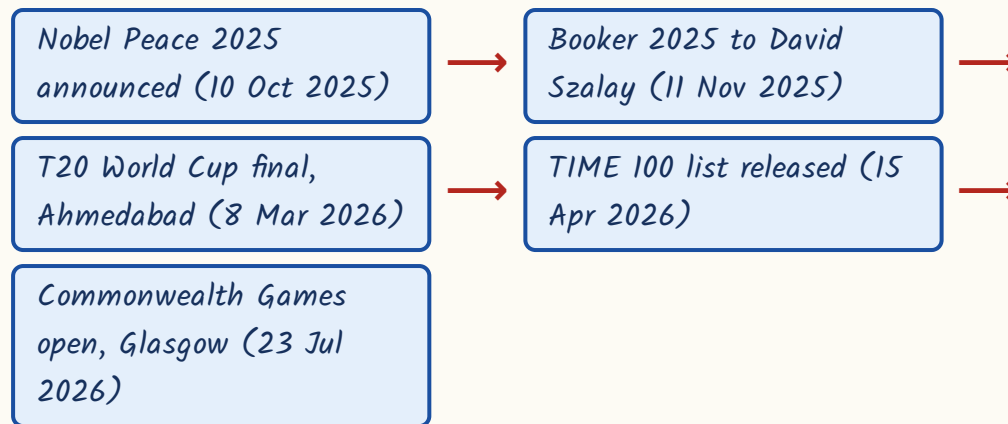
Place	Why it was in the news
Belem, Brazil	COP30, November 2025
Glasgow, Scotland	Commonwealth Games 2026
Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi	India AI Impact Summit, February 2026
Ahmedabad	ICC Men's T20 World Cup final, 8 March 2026
Visakhapatnam	Exercise MILAN 2026 and Google's \$15 billion AI hub
Paphos, Cyprus	FIDE Candidates 2026
Samarkand, Uzbekistan	Chess Olympiad 2026
Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	Asian Games 2026

Now the TIME lists — treat this as a named repeat topic, not a stray fact. The TIME 100 Most Influential People list for 2026 was released on 15 April 2026. Three names matter for India: actor RANBIR KAPOOR, whose profile was written by Ayushmann Khurrana; chef VIKAS KHANNA; and Google CEO SUNDAR PICHAI.

ASKED IN RAS

TIME's influential and pioneers lists were asked in RAS Pre 2021 and RAS Pre 2023 — two papers within three years, which in RPSC terms makes it a live category, not a one-off. The question is always 'which Indian featured in the TIME list of year X'. Learn the Indian names for 2026 and be ready to add any new TIME list published in October or November 2026.

Chronology of this chapter — the order RPSC asks



What in this chapter will have moved by December — and where to check

This is the most perishable chapter in the whole book. Between September and December 2026 a full Asian Games, a Nobel season, a Booker and possibly a World Chess Championship all happen. Do not re-read the chapter in December. Keep one loose page titled 'Sept to Dec 2026 — sports and awards', two columns only, the event or prize and the name, and add a line the day you read the news. In the last fortnight that page, not the chapter, is what you revise.

- *ASIAN GAMES, Aichi-Nagoya, 19 September to 4 October 2026 — India's medal tally, gold medallists and any Rajasthani medallist. The single biggest gap in these notes.*
- *Asian Para Games, October 2026 — same treatment.*
- *Nobel Prizes 2026 — announced in the first half of October. Peace and Literature belong in this chapter.*
- *Booker Prize 2026 — usually announced in November.*
- *Youth Olympic Games, Dakar, 31 October to 13 November 2026, and the World Chess Championship due in December 2026.*

- National Sports Awards for the 2026 cycle, and whether the Khel Ratna is conferred this time.
- Padma Awards 2027 are announced on the eve of Republic Day 2027 — that is AFTER your exam, so the 2026 list above stays the current one.
- Any new TIME list, and obituaries of major figures between September and December 2026.

CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 in the RAJASTHANI language is not recorded in these notes. It has been asked twice in RAS (2018, 2023). Look it up at sahitya-akademi.gov.in and write it into this chapter before December — it is the cheapest mark available in this whole section.

REVISION RECAP

1. Commonwealth Games 2026 — Glasgow, 23 July to 2 August; India 4th with 39 medals (13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze).
2. India topped the boxing table at Glasgow with 7 golds and 3 silvers.
3. Arundhati Choudhary of KOTA, Rajasthan — boxing gold, women's 70 kg, beat Chantelle Reid of England. The Rajasthan answer of this window.
4. Lovlina Borgohain took silver (women's 75 kg); Neeraj Chopra took silver in the javelin; Gulveer Singh was India's only double medallist.
5. Other golds: Mirabai Chanu (weightlifting 48 kg), Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh (judo), Sharmila Dhankar, Dilip Gavitt and Soman Rana (para athletics).
6. ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 — hosted by India; final at Ahmedabad 8 March 2026; India beat New Zealand by 96 runs for a record third title.
7. ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025 — India's first ODI world title, beating South Africa in the final.
8. 2026 hosts: Winter Olympics Milan, FIFA World Cup USA-Mexico-Canada, BWF Worlds New Delhi, Chess Olympiad Samarkand, Asian Games Aichi-Nagoya.
9. National Sports Awards 2025 — Khel Ratna NOT conferred; committee under Justice Arun Kumar Mishra; 17 Arjuna awardees.
10. Arjuna Lifetime 2025 to I. Arumainayagam (football); Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar to the Army Paralympic Node, Pune.

11. Padma Awards 2026 — 131 in all: 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, 113 Shri.
12. Republic Day 2026 gallantry — 70 awards including 6 posthumous; 3 Kirti Chakras and 13 Shaurya Chakras.
13. Peacetime gallantry order: Ashoka, Kirti, Shaurya. Wartime: Param Vir, Maha Vir, Vir Chakra.
14. Nobel 2025 — Peace: Maria Corina Machado; Literature: Laszlo Krasznahorkai; Economics: Mokyr, Aghion and Howitt.
15. Booker Prize 2025 — David Szalay for 'Flesh'; 60th Jnanpith — R. Vairamuthu (Tamil); 59th — Vinod Kumar Shukla (Hindi).
16. Sahitya Akademi 2025 — 'Crimson Spring' by Navtej Sarna (English), 'Jeete Jee Allahabad' by Mamta Kalia (Hindi).
17. Oscars 2026 — 'One Battle After Another' (Best Picture), Paul Thomas Anderson, Michael B. Jordan, Jessie Buckley. Phalke for 2023 — Mohanlal.
18. Abel Prize Gerd Faltings; Pritzker Smiljan Radic; Templeton Simon Conway Morris; Indira Gandhi Peace Prize 2025 Graca Machel.
19. TIME 100 of 2026, released 15 April — Ranbir Kapoor, Vikas Khanna, Sundar Pichai. TIME lists were asked in RAS 2021 and 2023.
20. Obituaries — Ram Sutar (Statue of Unity sculptor, 18 Dec 2025), Swaraj Kaushal, Baba Adhav, Kalyan Chatterjee.